IELTS ACADEMIC READING

Volume 8

6 complete Academic Reading tests — three full passages and 40 questions each — with a complete answer key and passage evidence for every answer

IB

6
FULL TESTS

240
QUESTIONS

Full
ANSWER KEY

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Introduction

Welcome to **IELTS Academic Reading — Volume 8**, a printable practice book of 6 complete Reading tests, compiled and prepared by Teacher Ibodullaev Bekhruz.

Every test follows the real exam format: three passages of increasing difficulty and 40 questions covering the full range of IELTS question types — True/False/Not Given, Matching Headings, Matching Information, Multiple Choice, Summary and Sentence Completion, and more. Answer circles and blank lines are left for you to write your answers, just like on test day.

Part One contains all 6 tests with questions only, so you can practise without seeing any answers. **Part Two** contains the complete Answer Key for each test, with the keywords from each question and the exact sentence in the passage that proves the correct answer.

How to use this book:

- Sit each test in one go, under timed conditions — 60 minutes for all three passages.
- Write your answers directly in the circles and blanks provided.
- Check your answers in Part Two and read the passage evidence for every question you got wrong.
- Use the band-score table on the answer key pages to estimate your result, then revisit weak question types.

Good luck with your preparation, and follow **@bekhruzposts** for more free IELTS materials.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 1

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Steam Across the Water

A look at the early history of boats powered by steam

During the 1600s, very early in the development of steam engines, inventive spirits like the Frenchman Denis Papin dreamed of – and experimented with – boats driven by steam, rather than by the wind or human effort, but many decades passed before those visions became reality.

Englishman Jonathan Hulls took out patents on a steamboat in 1736, but it was to be driven by a Newcomen engine, which was heavy and therefore inefficient, and would never be a success. In 1763, William Henry, an American, put a Watt steam engine in a boat, but it sank. Nearly 20 years later, in the 1780s, a steam-powered paddle-wheeler managed to last fifteen minutes against the current on the River Saone in France, but lacked the endurance for longer trips. Developments elsewhere included a boat driven by a steam-powered water-jet and able to do six kilometres per hour. However, all these steamboats were either too slow or too expensive to run.

For example, American John Fitch successfully trialled his first steamboat in 1787, but although he tried a number of designs and solved many technical challenges – one of his boats could even travel at 13 km/h – he could never convince sceptics that steamboats would pay.

The 19th century came before real success could be claimed. In Scotland in 1802, Lord Dundas launched the steamboat Charlotte Dundas, which was driven by a paddle wheel and had an improved engine designed by William Symington. Barges, some weighing as much as 70 tonnes, were towed by this steamboat 30 kilometres along the Forth and Clyde Canal to Glasgow, Scotland's second city.

Soon after, success came to American Robert Fulton, whose countrymen called him 'the father of the steamboat'. Inspired by news of the Charlotte Dundas, Fulton ran steamboat trials on the River Seine, in an attempt to attract French support for his submarine Nautilus. He later imported a Boulton-Watt steam engine and built a boat to use it in. In 1807, the Clermont began a scheduled passenger steamboat service between New York and

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Albany, 250 kilometres up the Hudson River, taking 30 hours for the trip. Within a few years, steamers were running on the St Lawrence River in Canada and soon appeared on other rivers and lakes, including the Mississippi River.

Back in Scotland, Fulton's ideas inspired Henry Bell, who launched his Comet in 1812 on the Clyde between Glasgow and Greenock. Within a decade, dozens of steamboats were operating on the rivers, lochs and canals of Scotland, carrying cargo and occasionally passengers. The age of steamboats had arrived.

Once steamboats were carrying passengers and industrial goods along inland waterways and sheltered coastlines, the challenge became to send them across the open ocean. Engines needed to use less coal so ships could remain at sea for several weeks. Paddle wheels also had to be replaced by power sources less affected by rolling seas.

Despite this, the first Atlantic crossings using both steam and sail began in 1819 with the American ship Savannah. A regular service followed two decades later with the establishment of the Cunard Line in 1840, offering guaranteed sailing dates. Cunard's early ships used both sail and steam, but the era of steam-only passenger liners soon followed.

British engineer Isambard Kingdom Brunel led ship design innovation. His Great Western, launched in 1838, crossed the Atlantic in fifteen days. His Great Britain (1853) was the first iron ocean-going steamship and the first to use a screw propeller instead of paddle wheels. The largest paddle steamer ever built was Brunel's Great Eastern, later used to lay the first submarine telegraph cable.

Modern ships now use steam turbines, diesel engines or fuel oil. Atlantic crossings can be completed in four days, but today's vessels are still descendants of the early visions of Papin and Fulton.

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Questions 1–6

Complete the table below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The Development of Steamboats

Date	Event
1600s	Early inventors like Papin started to develop boats that relied on steam instead of manpower or wind.
1730s	The engine of Jonathan Hulls' steamboat was (1) _____ due to its weight.
1780s	A French paddle steamer did not have the (2) _____ to keep going for more than a quarter of an hour. John Fitch overcame a number of (3) _____ problems with his steamboat designs.
Early 1800s	The Charlotte Dundas pulled barges to Glasgow. In France, Fulton used a steamboat to try to raise interest in a (4) _____ Passengers in the US began to be carried regularly by a steamboat called the (5) _____
1812 onwards	In Scotland, steamboats transported some passengers, but mostly (6) _____

Questions 7–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(7) For steamboats to cross the Atlantic Ocean, engines which used fuel economically were needed.

(8) Using paddle wheels guaranteed reliability on ocean crossings.

(9) The Savannah was much faster than a regular paddle steamer.

(10) Brunel preferred designing railways to steamships.

(11) The Great Britain had more than one innovative feature.

(12) The design of the riverboat Archimedes was widely admired.

(13) Modern ships that cross the Atlantic use the same energy source as the early steamships.

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Reading Passage 2

IQ Scores

How they are changing and what the changes mean

A Studies from numerous countries suggest that IQ scores have been rising fast since at least the 1950s – enough to mean that someone with an IQ classed as average at that time could be labelled as having low intelligence today. However, psychologists disagree about what the upward trend in scores really means. Some researchers argue that people are not getting more intelligent overall, but just getting better at a particular sort of problem solving. Others say they have found echoes of rising IQ scores in 'real world' measures of intelligence. To confuse things still more, there are hints that the trend may be about to grind to a halt.

B James Flynn, a professor of political science, first showed that IQ scores were rising in the mid-1980s, and became famous after others dubbed the pattern he had observed the 'Flynn effect'. In a landmark paper he made detailed comparisons across fourteen countries of trends in the results of tests that measure reasoning power. Overall, these showed a real growth in scores of up to 25 points in a generation. To find out more, Flynn went on to look at scores for each type of reasoning that IQ tests set out to measure, such as verbal, numerical and visuo-spatial. This last test category usually includes 'Raven's matrices' – sequential patterns with one piece missing. The candidate has to choose, from a set of alternatives, which shape to put in the empty space. When Flynn took a closer look at the scores, the pattern was clear. The strongest gains in almost every case were on Raven's matrices and similar tests, while verbal and arithmetical scores showed more modest rises. Since presenting his original paper, Flynn has looked at data from further countries and found the same upward trend, with the same skills responsible for most of the increase.

C Flynn feels that his eponymous effect is meaningful, but does not interpret it as evidence that people are becoming cleverer. Our grandparents were not retarded and we are not geniuses, he says. More likely we have simply developed the skills and habits of mind that make us better at solving abstract problems, and – just as importantly – we take such problems seriously. Flynn believes that demands of visuo-spatial abilities have grown because of TV, computers and cars, and also that in societies where intelligence has become something people focus on excessively, abstract problem-solving skills develop faster than other skills.

D Others have different views about what might account for the increase in IQ scores. John Rust of the University of London suggests that it is not just an increase in visuo-spatial activities that is pushing up IQ scores. He believes that there are several factors,

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including the fact that, in more complex societies, people have to think harder to find solutions to problems they face. He also points out that if just one mind grasps a new concept, such as Einstein and the theory of relativity, it may then be easier for society in general to think in a more complex way. Others, such as experimental psychologist Robert Howard, argue that overall intelligence really has risen, helped by better nutrition, smaller families, wider access to education and other environmental changes.

E Howard's latest research has sent him on a different line of enquiry. Controversially, he now believes that the rise in IQ scores might have peaked in industrialised countries. To support this view, he cites data from Denmark. The Danish military still summons virtually all young men before a draft board to identify who is suitable to do military service. Since 1957, all 17-year-olds there have taken exactly the same qualifying IQ tests – including ones similar to Raven's matrices. Candidates must also be able to answer verbal questions such as 'Sun is to day as Moon is to ?', and number-series questions such as '2, 3, 5, 8, ?'. Results in these tests have been carefully analysed by Thomas Teasdale, a neuropsychologist. He found that during the 1960s and '70s, scores showed gains on a scale similar to those of other countries, but by the 1990s the rate of improvement had slowed right down to about one IQ point over the decade. Furthermore, the scores were improving only on the visuo-spatial questions; verbal and numerical performance was flattening out. Most intriguingly, however, scores from 1999 onwards show an overall downturn. One explanation might be that there is some absolute ceiling to people's abilities to perform these tasks, no matter how much the prevailing culture encourages them. However, as Teasdale points out, if such a ceiling had been reached, the test results should show scores pushing against it rather than actually falling.

F Flynn is keeping a close eye on the findings, but is not jumping to conclusions until data from other countries is available. However, he does wonder whether the conditions leading to dramatic improvements in mental ability disappear as societies become more prosperous. He points out that in human history, prosperity often led to decadence, and argues that the case of ancient Rome can be viewed as an illustration of this.

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Questions 14–18

Look at the following statements and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–D**.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A James Flynn

B John Rust

C Robert Howard

D Thomas Teasdale

Q	Statement	Answer
14	Modern technology has influenced some aspects of intelligence.	
15	IQ scores may not yet have reached a natural limit.	
16	Improved diet has a positive effect on mental powers.	
17	Exceptional individuals can have an impact on collective intelligence.	
18	As societies become more sophisticated the need for problem-solving skills increases.	

Questions 19–22

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
19	An account of a selection procedure involving a particular group of people.	
20	A description of one component of a visuo-spatial test.	
21	An overview of the different interpretations of IQ score trends.	
22	An example of the negative effect affluence may have on IQ trends.	

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Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

James Flynn

During the (23) _____, James Flynn conducted research showing that IQ scores were increasing. Flynn then analyzed specific kinds of reasoning ability separately. He found that tests called (24) _____, which measured visuo-spatial skills, accounted for the biggest score increases, whereas scores in numerical and (25) _____ components rose less steeply. Results from research in other (26) _____, which Flynn has examined more recently, are consistent with his earlier findings.

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Reading Passage 3

Practical Learning in the Classroom

A teacher describes a case study involving middle school students and traditional earthen architecture

A The way we think about architecture in schools has come a long way. Once, studying architecture in the art class meant learning to appreciate great buildings art-history style, through slide presentations. In recent years, though, the American Institute of Architects has fostered the idea that the process of architectural design, not just the appreciation of architecture, is a beneficial aspect of the art curriculum.

B The value of architectural design is that it is the concrete training ground for a broadly applicable creative process. Architectural training can help people design structures to meet needs. It can help farmers design crop rotations to meet needs. Furthermore, it provides hands-on experiences that reinforce learning in various other subjects, from math to social studies.

C In the ongoing dialogue about architecture in the middle school art curriculum, many believe students should actually build the structures they design in their courses. Although the technology and expertise required of modern architecture can prohibit students from actually realizing their designs, traditional architectural materials and methods remain quite accessible to the art classroom. Traditional architectural materials, such as earth, clay and straw, are cheap, easy to work with and readily available. Further, when students participate in the construction or preservation of a traditional earthen structure in their local community, they engage in a form of experiential learning and they are motivated to invest in the project. This is evident in a case study of an adobe conservation project with middle school students in the town of Zuni, New Mexico, in the Southwestern United States.

D Traditional architecture reaches back to preindustrial America, when local resources and cultures produced structures in styles unique to each region. In New Mexico, examples of hand-built earthen structures still abound. The region has seen some decline in traditional architecture as industrialization has brought new building codes and materials; however, the traditional, non-industrial home, either preserved from earlier generations or newly built, remains in use. Traditional building materials and the land that supplies them are so accessible that handcrafting a house still remains feasible.

E Thus, with no technical expertise and little cost, middle school students can participate in the construction or preservation of a traditional earthen structure. During the project, a student will get to know the materials, understand the chemistry, solve problems, work with classmates, and exercise muscles. The student can apply knowledge of design

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principles and the creative process while participating in a cooperative effort. But most significantly, this type of project-based activity motivates students to invest intellectually and emotionally in the outcome.

F The town of Zuni, where I taught art, was surrounded by adobe construction, new and old. Behind our main high school building there was a one-room adobe structure which was once used for teaching. Now it served as a place where old furniture could be kept. I sent my class home with the oral history assignment to ask their family, friends and neighbors questions to find out about that building. From their research we compiled a sketchy history: it began as a kindergarten classroom; it later became an art classroom; now it was full of broken desks.

G The building's design kept it relatively warm in the winter, even without heating, due to its broad south face, and it stayed cool in the summer due to its spacious, ventilated attic and massive earthen walls. Because of this, my students agreed it was worth preserving and were enthusiastic about helping. Preservationist Shalie Gasper arrived in the fall to help with an assessment of the building's needs. She recommended replacing the stucco that encased the original adobe walls with a traditional mud plaster. She showed us where to find local supplies of sand and clay soil for the plaster mix. We began work on the stucco removal in late fall. The next spring the students were ready to replaster. To teach the traditional skills, Gasper and other local specialists joined us. They gave my class three full mornings of intensive workshops on history and preservation as well as mud-plastering technique, and the building got a new coat of traditional mud plaster.

H Small design-and-build projects such as this can be seen through to the finish when working with earth in the art curriculum. A simple landscape feature such as a wall, entryway, or arch can draw students into important aspects of design that involve the structure's interaction with people, the surrounding landscape, and natural elements. The same project may provide an opportunity to focus on the chemistry of soil or the structural dynamics of construction. Design goals might guide students to involve traditional forms, consider formal aspects, or integrate math skills of measuring and estimating.

I During our traditional architecture unit, the students realized that something old and almost forgotten is valuable and worth preserving. Many others in the community and around the country share this renewal of interest in traditional earthen technologies. It is the connection to a cultural heritage that interests some; the quality of living within massive, natural walls that attracts others; or for others, the sustainability of the process and the minimal energy spent in construction. The value of adobe in general is becoming more and more known, but little has been said about its value in the art curriculum until now. This experiment in adobe conservation with middle school students convinced me that traditional architecture deserves a place in the regular curriculum.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct answer.

27 What education initiative does the American Institute of Architects currently promote?

A multimedia presentation of information in classrooms
B the study of monumental buildings throughout history
C the practice of designing architectural structures
D processes to add more art classes in schools

28 In the third paragraph, what problem with teaching architecture on art courses does the writer note?

A Technology-based courses are unavailable.
B Students cannot always construct their designs.
C The curriculum is too traditional.
D Students lack motivation.

29 What is the greatest benefit for students that the writer sees in a traditional architecture project?

A personal connection to the end result
B participation in a cooperative project
C building of problem-solving skills
D conservation of a traditional building

30 What is the purpose of the eighth paragraph?

A to explain why it is important that projects be small
B to outline the multiple skills involved in one project
C to discuss strategies for connecting content areas
D to propose suggestions for traditional earth projects

31 What does the writer say about traditional building and the general population?

A Earthen architecture is becoming a profitable business.
B Earthen architecture is less feasible in some areas of the country.
C Interest in earthen architecture varies from region to region.
D People are attracted to earthen architecture for different reasons.

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Questions 32–36

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–H**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS

A Experts **B** location **C** design **D** storage
E students **F** resources **G** training **H** businesses

The students in Zuni chose to renovate an old building which was being used for (32) _____. They came to an agreement that the building was worthy of rehabilitation based on its functional (33) _____. At the beginning of the project, students were given the task of discovering the history of the building through interviews with local residents. During the course of the project, they learned where to locate (34) _____ for the project. They also worked closely with a number of (35) _____ on each step of the project. During the project, students were also given (36) _____ to build useful skills.

Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

(37) The price of materials is one drawback to using traditional architecture.

(38) Earthen structures can easily be built in all regions of the U.S.

(39) Working with a traditional earthen structure can have physical benefits.

(40) A traditional architecture curriculum is best suited to middle school level students.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 2

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Australia's Cane Toad Problem

Australia's attempt to control pests has itself become a pest

A In the north of Australia there are many sugar cane plantations, which early in the 20th century were being damaged by a particular pest. This was a species of beetle whose larvae, the infant form of the beetle, live underground in the soil in the sugar cane fields. The sugar cane plants were weakened or died because their roots were eaten by the larvae. This had serious economic consequences for sugar cane farmers. Modern pesticides were not developed until the 1940s, so farmers had to use what was available at the time. Chemicals like arsenic and copper were used, but these were not only expensive but also stayed in the environment and were poisonous to people, plants and animals. It was generally acknowledged by government, farmers and scientists that cheaper and safer methods of pest control had to be found.

B A promising replacement for copper and arsenic was the use of biological control. Farmers already used some forms of biological pest control in the form of predatory and parasitic wasps and flies, insect-eating birds, and plants from different regions or countries to control pests. Common practice was to release these introduced agents into new environments, the expectation being that they would destroy resident pests. Some species of toad already had successful records as agents of biological control in gardens. For example, in 19th-century France, toads were sold to gardeners at markets in Paris to eat insect pests in their gardens. In the early 20th century French sugar cane farmers first took giant toads from South America to control pests in their Caribbean sugar cane plantations. Although there is no evidence that these toads did help to control pests, sugar cane scientists then carried some of these toads from Jamaica and Barbados to Puerto Rico and from there to Hawaii.

C The idea of biological control of pests was not new to Australia. For example, in 1926 there had been a highly successful prevention of the increase of the exotic prickly-pear cactus by the introduction of a moth from Argentina. This success added strength to the argument that biological control was the answer to the sugar cane industry's pest problems. Accordingly, in the early 1930s a decision was taken to introduce the giant South American toads, which in Australia are now commonly called cane toads, into Australian sugar cane plantations.

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D In 1935, an Australian entomologist brought 101 cane toads from Hawaii and released them in sugar cane plantations in the north of Australia. However, over the following years it became clear that the cane toads were a failure. There was a fatal flaw in the plan to use them as a form of biological control. This was that earthbound cane toads were expected to eat the mostly flying adult beetles in order to eliminate the soil-dwelling beetle larvae that ate the roots of the sugar cane plants. This, of course, cane toads could not do.

E Prior to their introduction in Australia, there had been very few opponents and only one made his views public. He was a retired former Chief Entomologist from the state government of New South Wales named Walter Froggatt. He forecast that cane toads might become as great a pest in Australia as rabbits. However, Froggatt's peers rebuked him and eminent scientists branded his views 'decidedly pessimistic'. It is estimated that today as many as a hundred million cane toads form a toxic infestation which is slowly spreading throughout the land.

F Cane toads are large, heavily built amphibians. Average-sized adults are 10–15 cm long and weigh more than a kilogram. They have large swellings on each shoulder from which they squirt poison when they are threatened. This venom contains 14 different chemicals, but they do not appear to be harmful to humans, as no-one has died in Australia from cane toad poison. Until recently there was no understanding of the toxicity of cane toad poison, but it is now clear that freshwater crocodiles, goannas (large lizards) and dingoes (wild dogs) have died after eating cane toads. Cane toads compete with native Australian fauna for food, and eat the eggs and young of ground-nesting birds. As their numbers increase, they are taking over more and more of the land where native Australian fauna live.

G The lesson that can be learned from the introduction of cane toads is important. It is wrong to think that such an ecological disaster could not be repeated. In this instance, the catalyst was the overwhelming consensus of support for introducing cane toads to Australia. The error was that there was little or no testing of these biological agents before they were introduced, to see what unplanned effects they might have on the environment.

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Questions 1–7

Complete the table below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Pest Control

Early 20th-century problems in Australia
The larvae of a type of (1) ——— were a serious pest in sugar cane fields.
Its larvae ate the (2) ——— of the plant.
Chemical pesticides were unsatisfactory because they were: poisonous; (3) ———; difficult to remove from the ground
Experiences with biological pest control
The use of insects, plants and birds was widespread.
In the 19th century French (4) ——— used toads.
In Australia a (5) ——— stopped the spread of prickly-pear cactus.
Cane toads were brought to Australia from (6) ———
Cane toads proved to be a (7) ——— as pest control.

Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(8) The outcome of the introduction of cane toads was immediately obvious.

(9) Rabbits were introduced to Australia to control weeds.

(10) Walter Froggatt was criticised for his efforts to stop the introduction of the cane toad to Australia.

(11) The average size of cane toads has increased since their introduction.

(12) Australian animals can eat cane toads safely.

(13) In many places cane toads are gaining control of the habitats of Australian fauna.

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Reading Passage 2

Farmers

An iconic chain store in New Zealand reaches a milestone

A The chain of stores known as Farmers began one hundred years ago as a mail order company. Today the Farmers chain employs 3,500 staff across 58 branches making it the most venerable institution of its type in New Zealand. 'Coming to Farmers once a week has become woven into the fabric of New Zealand culture,' says business historian Ian Hunter. By 1960, one in every ten people had an account with the company. It was not only a shop but also hosted the largest annual parade in the country, the Santa parade each Christmas time. Gary Blumenthal, whose family have been customers for three generations, understands well the role Farmers have played in New Zealand culture. 'We were on holiday in Auckland,' he explains, 'and I decided that the lookout tower on top of the Farmers building would be a unique place to fit the ring on my new fiancee's finger.' The couple has been married for 50 years.

B Farmers' longevity can be attributed to the philosophy fostered by Robert Laidlaw, the Scottish immigrant who established the business. Right from the outset, Laidlaw guaranteed customer satisfaction, and those who were not entirely happy with a purchase would receive a full refund with no questions asked. This was certainly the first time such a guarantee had been made by a New Zealand retailer and was probably one of the first worldwide. Laidlaw believed that the scheme could work if he ensured that every product sold was of the highest quality relative to its price.

C Another important aspect of the Farmers' philosophy was to internationalize the New Zealand market. By the time the Hobson Street store opened in 1920 in order to sell directly to customers for the first time, Laidlaw had established buying offices in New York and London so as to offer his customers the latest designs. This was a bold move in those days and won Farmers a devoted following. It's also true that whoever you speak to regarding Farmers in the early years, whether managers or workers, they all emphasize how the company represented a large family. Everyone employed by Laidlaw felt they were building something that would ultimately be to the benefit of the whole country. For example, to mark the centenary celebrations, 58 Farmers' stores around the country announced the neighborhood charities they would raise funds for – everything from guide dog services to volunteer fire brigades will benefit.

D Farmers has always had a heart, according to former board chairman Rawdon Busfield. 'One day I was in the Hobson Street store and a woman came in with two small children – they didn't have a lot of money, you could tell. That week we had a special on, a big bar of chocolate for a shilling... But the boy only had a penny. I took the penny and gave him the

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chocolate.' However, not everything has stayed the same. Farmers was once home to genteel tea rooms, children's playgrounds, and an annual sale to celebrate the birthday of Hector the Parrot – who came to embody the store in the eyes of many shoppers and who died, aged 131, in the 1970s. You could buy houses from Farmers, and its saddle factory supplied the armed forces. In fact, although the company has grown considerably over the years, today it sells a narrower assortment of products than in the past.

E Walk through a Farmers store today and you'll see big changes. Its most recent branch in the suburb of Albany is filled with bright lights and big brands. The branch sells cosmetics from 16 different international companies and buys from approximately 500 suppliers, of which about 30 percent are locally owned. 'Eight or ten years ago,' says current chief executive Rod McDermott, 'lots of brands wouldn't partner with us. We weren't in trouble as such, but we could have been doing much better because we were focused too much on price and not on fashion. The reorientation of the last decade has seen a great improvement.'

F Farmers almost didn't pull through one economic crisis. In the mid-1980s, business was booming and the company had stores throughout the country. Then, with sales topping $375 million, it was taken over by Chase Corporation. Lincoln Laidlaw, the son of the company's founder, remembers the dark days following the stock market crash of 1987 and the collapse of the Chase Corporation. 'The business was being divided up,' he says, 'and I believe that the original culture of the store was dispelled and it hasn't been recovered. That's a shame, but the business is still strong.' For a few turbulent years the stores were controlled first by a consortium of Australian banks, and later a local corporation. In 2003, it went back into 'family' ownership with the purchase by the James Pascoe Group owned by an established New Zealand retail family. Brand power has made Farmers profitable again, according to McDermott. 'And now we're becoming the brand we used to be... It's like the rebirth of an icon.'

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Questions 14–18

Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, **A–F**.

Q	Statement	Answer
14	A mention of the company being sold.	
15	A reference to how the range of goods for sale has become more limited.	
16	An example of an innovative offer made by the company's founder.	
17	A description of a romantic event on the shop's roof.	
18	A description of the latest store in the chain.	

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Questions 19–22

Complete the sentences below. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage.*

Farmers was set up as a/an (19) ———— business before it became a chain.

Robert Laidlaw set up (20) ———— overseas so he could sell up-to-date fashions.

According to employees, Farmers was like a/an (21) ————

Farmers held a/an (22) ———— once a year in honour of the company's famous pet.

Questions 23–26

Match each person with the correct idea, **A–F**.

LIST OF IDEAS

A The character of the company has changed for the worse.

B The store is selling more local products than in the past.

C The company believes in offering lower prices than their competitors.

D The staff has always believed in generosity.

E The store is an integral part of the local way of life.

F The store needed to change its approach to business.

Q	Person	Answer
23	Ian Hunter	
24	Rawdon Busfield	
25	Rod McDermott	
26	Lincoln Laidlaw	

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Reading Passage 3

Life on Mars?

A When scientists began observing Mars with their first primitive telescopes, they assumed from the start that the planet was peopled. The 18th-century astronomer William Herschel, noting the seasons and atmosphere of Mars, declared that 'its inhabitants enjoy a situation similar to our own'. A century later, astronomers asserted that they could detect canals running across the Martian landscape. These canals, argued US scientist Percival Lowell, had been built by technologically advanced Martians to transport water from the poles to the equator of their drying world. 'Martian folk are possessed of inventions of which we have not dreamed,' he argued.

B The vision of an advanced culture trapped on a drying world was taken up by the British writer H.G. Wells in 1898 in his masterpiece The War of the Worlds, in which Earth is subjected to a pitiless invasion from a race of hideous Martians armed with poison gas and heat rays. Martians became synonymous with grotesque, threatening aliens, at least as far as the public was concerned. Scientists were more restrained, but still supported the idea that the planet might support relatively complex life forms.

C Then, in the late 1960s, rocket science changed our image of Mars forever. The US Mariner probes swept past Mars and sent back pictures, not of a world covered in vegetation, as many scientists still expected, but of vistas of cratered, arid deserts. Finally, in 1975, two huge US probes settled on the Martian surface and began a series of experiments aimed at pinpointing, once and for all, the existence of air-breathing organisms. None were found, for the Viking probes landed in areas as dead as the Sahara Desert. All that was sent back were images of a bleak, boulder-strewn terrain. Mars was declared officially dead – for a while.

D Since that time, two critical pieces of evidence have been found on Earth which support the idea that Mars has life. The first is known as ALH84001, a meteorite that was blasted into space when a large body struck Mars 15 million years ago and which spiralled across the solar system to crash into the Antarctic. Analysis carried out by NASA scientist Imre Friedmann showed that the meteorite contained elements identical to those found on Mars by the Viking probes, and revealed chains of crystals similar to those created by earthbound bacteria. Friedmann believes that these could only have been created by living organisms. Others, however, argue that the crystals could have been laid down by simple chemical processes. A second area of support for the idea that living organisms could survive Mars's harshness has been provided by the study of extremophiles, bacteria that have been found in increasingly hostile landscapes on Earth – acid lakes, for example, and volcanoes.

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E In the past few years, astronomers have become convinced that the Martian surface, although hostile and arid today, was once lush and welcoming. Images sent back by recent probes such as the Mars Global Surveyor have revealed dried-up riverbeds and old estuaries. Rivers poured into ancient seas, it appears, and rain swept the sodden terrain. Then catastrophe struck. Mars lost its magnetic field several billion years ago, explains British astronomer Paul Murdin. 'Earth retained one, and it protects our atmosphere. Without that protection, Mars's gases and water boiled off.' That is why they are so different today.

F The discovery of signs of water on Mars has changed everything. Some researchers believe that water from underground reservoirs still gushes through Martian valleys as occasional flash floods bubble to the surface. In the 1990s, the Mars Odyssey probe began to map the chemical make-up of the Mars soil, and discovered that much of the ground in the southern hemisphere of Mars is mixed with large quantities of ice. And where there is ice, there is likely to be liquid water, probably underneath. 'There are huge underground reservoirs on Mars,' says Marcello Coradini, head of planetary exploration for the European Space Agency. 'I am now convinced of that.'

G Current projects are hoping to clarify the question of the presence of water once and for all. These are aimed at conducting experiments to detect the presence of a substance called carbon 13 in soil and rock samples on Mars; this would be, according to some researchers, an unequivocal indicator of the presence of living organisms, past or present.

H But would the presence of a few Martian organisms alter our world view in any significant way? Professor Juan Perez Mercader of Madrid's Centre for Astrobiology in Spain believes that it would. 'For a start, we will be able to find out if Martian organisms have DNA, the golden molecule that controls the replication of earthly creatures.' If there is no DNA, that would show that Martian biology is quite unlike Earth's, and that on two planets, side by side in the same solar system, life evolved independently. If DNA is located, it would mean that life on Mars and on Earth may spring from the same source. 'If organisms can pop up that easily, our chances of finding intelligent versions elsewhere in the universe will look extremely good,' Perez Mercader states. The discovery of any evidence of living organisms on Mars would also mean renewed purpose for manned space flight projects.

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Questions 27–32

Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, **A–H**.

Q	Statement	Answer
27	Evidence that a rock found on Earth originated on Mars.	
28	A plan to analyse material on Mars.	
29	The reason Mars is no longer similar to Earth.	
30	An observation suggesting that there is currently water on Mars.	
31	A claim that construction had taken place on Mars.	
32	A possibility that humans and Martians could share the same origins.	

Questions 33–36

Choose the correct answer.

33 The 18th-century astronomer William Herschel believed that

A the Martians were physically similar to humans.
B the Martian environment resembled that of Earth.
C members of the Martian race were extremely primitive.
D the climatic conditions on Mars were very dry.

34 At the end of the 19th century, the public's ideas about Martians changed because of

A scientific discussion.
B media reports.
C a work of literature.
D a magazine illustration.

35 What does the writer say happened in the 1960s?

A The appearance of some regions of Mars changed.
B Evidence of organisms was found on Mars.
C The Martian atmosphere was tested scientifically.
D Earlier beliefs about Mars were disproven.

36 The study of extremophiles suggests that

A organisms can survive on Mars.
B organisms on Earth are like those found on Mars.
C Martian conditions resemble those in Earth's volcanoes.
D Martian crystals can survive acid conditions.

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Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

37 Lowell believed that Martian technology was more developed than human technology.

38 Information gained from Viking probes remains unchallenged.

39 There is evidence that there has been significant climate change on Mars.

40 Spanish scientists plan to launch space probes if DNA is found on Mars.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 3

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The History of the Chicken

The story begins 10,000 years ago in a jungle in Asia and ends today in kitchens all over the world.

Chicken is the universal food of our era, crossing cultural boundaries with ease. With its mild taste and uniform texture, chicken presents a blank canvas for the national flavours of almost any cuisine. However, until the introduction of large-scale industrial production in the 20th century, the economic and nutritional contribution of chickens was small. Chickens were considered domestic birds that were useful to humanity, but unlike other animals such as the horse or the ox, they did little to change the course of history. Nonetheless, the chicken has inspired contributions to culture, art, cuisine, science and religion over the millennia. Chickens were, and still are, a sacred animal in some cultures. The hen is a worldwide symbol of nurturing and fertility. The rooster is a universal sign of masculinity.

The domesticated chicken has a complicated family tree stretching back 10,000 years. Recent DNA testing has shown that the chicken's wild ancestor is the red junglefowl. The bird's resemblance to modern chickens is seen in the red feathers on top of its head, the red flesh around its mouth, and its distinctive call in the morning. The females of this breed protect their eggs in the same way modern-day chickens do, and they make the same clucking sounds. In its habitat, which stretches from north-eastern India to the Philippines, the red junglefowl looks on the forest floor for insects, seeds and fruit, and flies up to nest in the trees at night. That is about as much flying as it can manage, a trait that made it relatively easy for humans to capture and domesticate it. However, the red junglefowl is not the sole ancestor of the modern chicken. Scientists have identified three closely related species that might have bred with the red junglefowl. Precisely how much genetic material these other birds contributed to the DNA of domesticated chickens is unknown. Recent research suggests that modern chickens inherited at least one trait their yellow skin-from the grey junglefowl of southern India.

Once chickens were domesticated, cultural contact, trade, migration and territorial conquest resulted in their introduction to different regions of the world over several thousand years. Chickens arrived in Egypt around 1750 BC as fighting birds and additions

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to zoos. Drawings of the birds decorated royal tombs containing treasures intended for the afterlife. However, it took another 100 years before chickens became popular among ordinary Egyptians.

During this period, Egyptians mastered the technique of artificial incubation, freeing hens to lay more eggs. Eggs hatch in three weeks only if the temperature remains around 38 degrees Celsius. They must be turned several times a day, and humidity must remain stable. Egyptians constructed large oven-like complexes with corridors and vents to control heat. These methods were kept secret for centuries.

Around the Mediterranean, archaeologists have uncovered chicken bones dating from about 800 BC. Chickens were considered a delicacy among the Romans, who developed culinary practices such as omelettes and stuffing birds. European farmers later adopted methods to fatten chickens, including feeding them bread soaked in wine. However, the chicken's status declined after the fall of the Roman Empire, and chicken farms disappeared. Birds returned to their former size.

Well into the 20th century, chickens played a minor role in diet and the economy. Production remained small-scale until antibiotics and vitamins were added to chicken feed, allowing birds to be raised indoors. This marked the rise of factory farming. Factory farming increased both supply and demand. Modern chickens convert grain into protein with great efficiency. Less than one kilogram of feed produces 400 grams of chicken, compared to three kilograms for the same amount of beef. A chick can now reach two kilograms in six weeks.

Chickens are also popular as pets. In the USA, exotic and heritage breeds are increasingly kept in backyards and sold for significant sums of money. Overall, the chicken's global success story spans evolution, agriculture and cuisine, with chickens now outnumbering humans nearly three to one.

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Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. Chicken is globally popular because it can be used for different styles of cooking.
2. Chickens have poor capacity for flight compared to Junglefowl.
3. Scientists believe that the domestic chicken has more than one ancestor.
4. A modern chicken has the same skin colour as the grey junglefowl.
5. After the Roman Empire ended, chicken consumption in Europe declined.
6. Some people criticise the methods involved in factory farming chickens.
7. In the USA, fewer people are keeping expensive breeds of chicken at home.

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Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The Domestication and Farming of Chickens

EGYPT

- In 1750 BC the first chickens were seen in Egyptian (8) ——— and used in fights.
- Pictures of chickens were used on the (9) ——— of kings and queens.
- Egyptians developed a method of egg (10) ——— that didn't involve hens.
- For eggs to hatch, heat and (11) ——— levels had to stay the same.
- The eggs were hatched in large (12) ———.

ROMANS

- Farmers gave chickens a mixture of bread and wine to make them bigger.

20TH-CENTURY FARMING

- Farmers started adding antibiotics and vitamins to chicken feed.
- Chickens were kept inside, and this became possible because of added antibiotics and (13) ———.

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Reading Passage 2

A Study of Introvert and Extrovert Characters

A We are often labelled as introverts or extroverts, and humans do seem to have biological propensities to behave in certain ways; some of us are naturally more talkative and sociable while others prefer more time alone. But, according to Canadian-born research psychologist Professor Brian Little, our traits are by no means fixed. In his book Me, Myself and Us: The Science of Personality and the Art of Well-Being, Little suggests that we are often able to override our biological make-up through the adoption of what he calls 'free-traits', which allow us to behave in a manner which contrasts with our natural selves. According to Little, we adopt these free-traits only when we need them, in order to meet the demands of different situations and reach targets and goals that are important to us – our 'persona projects'. These projects might be big (such as career ambitions) or small (like cleaning the car) and pursuing them shapes our day-to-day behavior and our relationships with friends, family and workmates.

B Little recommends that we might usefully think of ourselves as amateur scientists. We are continually exploring and testing the world around us to discover what works and what doesn't. We do things, say things, and then we observe the reactions and unconsciously store the results. We apply the knowledge gained from our 'experiments' to the advancement of our personal projects. Sometimes our personal project pursuit requires us to engage in free traits; at other times, we can just be ourselves. Little proposes that the successful pursuit of personal projects which are meaningful, manageable, supported by others and generate positive feelings can greatly impact our happiness and the quality of our lives.

C Professor Little and one of his graduate students, Sanna Balsari-Palsule, have looked into the experiences of employees in a range of organisations. The reason for basing the research on this environment, as Balsari-Palsule explains, is that 'in an ideal world, one's job would fit one's traits perfectly, but that's very rarely the case. As so much can hinge on how we behave with others while at work, I wanted to discover what happens when people push the limits of their ability to act out of character. Do employees experience detriments in their well-being or work performance and does this increase their chances of burnout?'

D Their findings suggest that extroverts initially experience advantages over introverts at work, in terms of getting noticed and promoted more rapidly. However, when introvert employees higher up in the organisation act out of character and take on extrovert traits, they have equal performance ratings to those extroverts, and do not report any negative effects of this use of free traits. Balsari-Palsule offers an explanation: introvert employees make frequent use of 'restorative resources'. These are spaces designed to allow employees

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to read quietly or simply relax in order to recover their equilibrium after a strenuous session of acting out of character that would otherwise leave them feeling drained. However, if the same employees were expected to act out of character for more prolonged periods, without the chance to recover, the benefits could quickly turn into costs.

E In the same study, however, extroverts report strikingly different, and much less rewarding, experiences of acting out of character. It appears that more outwardly confident personality types find it extremely hard – and stressful – to rein back their personalities and act as if they were introverted. We found this difference was most common among younger employees. It may be that introverts are generally so used to acting extrovertly in situations outside of the workplace that it becomes a relatively easy force of habit, particularly in Western cultures where extroversion is often highly valued. On the other hand, extrovert employees at the beginning of their careers are much less used to being isolated in an office for long periods of time, so may feel like caged animals, needing to feed off the energy of others in order to thrive, 'says Balsari-Palsule.

F In the second stage of research, Balsari-Palsule is looking into the idiosyncrasies of people's work projects and how the work environment plays a vital role in supporting or, in some cases, constraining them. For example, highly competitive environments, which place demands on employees to conform to certain types of behaviour, may leave little time for employees to pursue projects which are important to them on a personal level. This could eventually be detrimental to their well-being. She expects that a closer look at the influences of different factors in the work environment, in conjunction with how people behave, will shed more light on what acting out of character may lead to.

G The implications of Little and Balsari Palsule's research are numerous and need to be taken into account by businesses. Balsari-Palsule suggests that it would serve companies well not to dismiss the costs of free-trait acting. She points out that compromised psychological and physical well-being can quickly result in more frequent occurrences of absenteeism. She also believes that management should rely less on handing out personality surveys that pigeonhole employees into introvert and extrovert categories. Instead, organisations should adopt policies and build work environments that are supportive of free-trait expression, and also provide the spaces for people to be themselves. Furthermore, making these changes is also likely to lead to increases in productivity in the long run.

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Questions 14–20

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i How company culture can have a negative impact
ii Recommendations for employers
iii The pressure of restraining an outgoing nature
iv Why researchers decided to focus on the workplace
v How does personality influence your choice of career?
vi Examples of various contexts in which we might need to act out of character
vii How workplace facilities aid the success of one personality type
viii Learning by trial and error

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	
20	Paragraph G	

Questions 21 and 22

Which **TWO** *statements are made by Professor Brian Little in the first paragraph?*

A They can affect the degree to which people are content with what they have.
B They are not used by people all the time.
C They influence people's choice of profession.
D They are useful in the pursuit of objectives assigned by others.
E They enable people to act in ways which are not typical for them.

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Questions 23–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

In the second stage of her research, Balsari-Palsule will explore her theory that very competitive workplaces prevent employees from completing projects of personal (23) _____

The research done by Little and Balsari-Palsule has many (24) _____ for businesses.

Balsari-Palsule thinks that managers depend too much on (25) _____ aimed at determining personality types.

Balsari-Palsule thinks that relieving the stress caused by free-trait acting could boost a company's (26) _____ over time.

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Reading Passage 3

When the Senses Mix Together

A What is the colour of five? What is the sound of blue? To most of us such questions are either meaningless or suitable only for poetry. But for some people these are questions to which very precise answers can be given. Five, for example, for some people is green, while others say the sound of a guitar is like someone blowing on their ankles. People who 'see' colour in numbers or letters of the alphabet and 'feel' sensation in sound have synesthesia – meaning literally 'joined sensation' – an extraordinary condition that causes certain senses to 'leak' into one another.

B People whose senses behave in this way are called 'synesthetes'. Some synesthetes take pleasure in it. To me it's like other people see the world in black and white, says one, who sees every letter, number, sound and pain in colour. Others learn to keep it a secret for fear of people laughing at them. But to neurologists investigating the brain it is of great interest. 'When scientists study normal perception,' says Daniel Smilek of the University of Waterloo in Ontario, Canada, there are lots of things we don't question because most of us perceive in the same way. Synesthesia, because it's abnormal, can give us new insights into normal perception.

C Seventeenth-century English philosopher John Locke was the first westerner to describe synesthesia. He wrote about a man who experienced bright red as the sound of the trumpet. Later, the condition excited the imagination of nineteenth-century European painters, such as the non-synesthete Wassily Kandinsky, who believed synesthetes were like good, much-played violins, which vibrate in all their parts and fibres. But it proved impossible to research and people lost interest. Recently, however, advances in brain imaging have sparked renewed interest.

D Early claims that the multi-sensory experiences of synesthesia were linked with the hallucinations of mental illness have long been disproved. Until 1993, many researchers dismissed it as another name for a vivid imagination, but then an experiment by Simon Baron-Cohen of Cambridge University in the UK showed that synesthetes who, when tested, had linked particular colours or shapes to letters, gave the same answers in 92 per cent of instances when tested again a week later. Non-synesthetes, given similar examples to imagine, returned the same answers in only 37 per cent of instances.

E Although there is some overlap between synesthetes as to what colour is linked to what – 56 per cent see the letter 'o' as white – most of the responses are individual. There are 30 possible sensory combinations, but links between sounds and colours are the most common. Women are between two and eight times more likely than men to have the condition.

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F As yet there is no explanation for any of this, but small pieces of the jigsaw are emerging. A brain scanning experiment by Baron-Cohen in 1995 found that when synesthetes were listening to words, areas of the brain lit up that are normally only active in response to vision and colour. From this comes the notion that we may all have synesthesia at birth, when many parts of the brain are linked, but, as we develop, connections are pruned, so our senses become separated and the synesthetic mechanism is no longer intact. Somehow, synesthetes have kept their synaptic connections intact. It's an idea that has been challenged, however, on the grounds that if you give people certain drugs they will have synesthetic experiences, which suggests the mechanism is intact in adults but repressed.

G There are many more unanswered questions about synesthesia. For example, is the synesthete's colour response to a number five triggered by actually seeing the number five written on a page, or does the synesthete 'see' the colour just by thinking of the number five? The neurologist Vilyanur Ramachandran came up with a test for synesthesia which seemed to suggest it was the sight of the number that was important. He asked people to look at a page made up of specially drawn twos and fives that were a mirror image of each other. The fives were placed at random on the page but the twos were placed to form shapes such as circles or triangles. To most people the numbers just looked like a jumble without order, but to synesthetes the patterns made by the twos were very obvious as a different colour from the fives. 'This shows they were really sensing colour in the numbers they saw,' says Ramachandran 'Ideas don't form these kinds of patterns.'

H However, Smilek subsequently came up with evidence that what really matters is the idea of a number rather than the sight of it on a page. He asked a synesthete to do some simple mental arithmetic while looking at different coloured papers. The subject did not write her answers, but only thought of them and said them aloud. Smilek found that when the colour of the paper clashed with the colour of the answer, the subject's response was slower than when the colours were the same. An actual colour (the colour of the paper) could interfere with the colour of a number that existed only in her head (the answer to the mental arithmetic question). 'My research suggests that colour experiences coincide with the processing of meaning,' says Smilek. 'It's the concept of a number that's coloured.'

I So which is it? At present, we don't know, but in the future neurologists may be able to explain what's going on in the brains of people like the novelist Nabokov, who perceived the English 'a' as dark brown and the French 'e' as black.

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Questions 27–30

Match each statement with the correct person. You may use any letter more than once.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Daniel Smilek

B John Locke

C Simon Baron-Cohen

D Vilyanur Ramachandran

Q	Statement	Answer
27	For synesthetes, hearing the names of things affects the brain in the same way that looking at things does.	
28	Synesthetes are consistent in their association of a certain colour with a certain written symbol.	
29	One synesthete heard a particular musical instrument when he saw a certain colour.	
30	Because synesthetes experience things differently to other people, studying synesthesia can give fresh perspectives on how the senses usually work.	

Questions 31–35

Which paragraph, **A–I**, *contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
31	an investigation into synesthesia using modern medical technology	
32	a mention of a writer who was a synesthete	
33	a definition of synesthesia	
34	two different explanations of why synesthesia is uncommon in adults	
35	a reason why some synesthetes do not tell people about their experience	

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Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

36 The painter Kandinsky admired synesthetes.

37 It is no longer believed that synesthesia is associated with mental illness.

38 Equal numbers of men and women have synesthesia.

39 Synesthetes have greater powers of logic than people with normal perception.

40 It is possible that we are all born with synesthesia.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 4

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Pixar Story

The animation studio Pixar has experienced a number of challenges in its short history

A Between 2000 and 2005, under former Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Michael D. Eisner, the Walt Disney Company set its shareholder meetings in a series of cold-weather cities during cold-weather months. Many suspected that this had been done to discourage attendance by the company's increasingly restless shareholders. In 2006, however, there was no need for such measures. In October 2005, Chief Operating Officer Robert Iger had replaced Eisner as CEO. On taking charge, Iger quickly carried out a bold move, negotiating a buyout of Pixar Animation Studios. Although the price was high, the acquisition proved to be overwhelmingly popular.

B Pixar had started life twenty years earlier as Pixar Inc., a computer hardware company, one of hundreds dotting the landscape of the San Francisco Bay Area in California. Within the company, a tiny animation group made short promotional films that brought in practically no revenue; the group came close more than once to being shut down. When the Pixar Image Computer proved unprofitable, the company turned to selling animation software and making animated commercials, but it continued to lose money year after year.

C In 1991, when Disney agreed to finance the production of Pixar's first feature film for cinema release, Disney largely dictated the terms of the contract. In late 1993, Disney considered ordering Pixar to shut down production of the John Lasseter-directed film Toy Story because of problems with the script. At the time, Hollywood commentators doubted whether audiences would even sit through a full-length film made using the new medium of computer animation. It was unclear whether computer animation would prove to be a novelty that would quickly wear thin.

D Before long, however, circumstances changed dramatically. A succession of critically acclaimed and commercially successful animated feature films, beginning with the release of Toy Story in 1995 and followed by A Bug's Life and Finding Nemo, made Pixar the world's leading animation studio. Disney earned enormous profits from distributing the films. When Pixar's majority owner and CEO, Steve Jobs, cut off contract talks with Disney in early 2004, the business press focused on how Disney would cope. By that time, Pixar

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films accounted for approximately 45 per cent of the operating income from Disney's film operations. Internal market research also showed that mothers of young children trusted the Pixar brand more than Disney's.

E As a result of the 2005 acquisition, John Lasseter soon assumed the roles of Chief Creative Officer for both Disney and Pixar Animation, as well as Principal Creative Adviser for Disney's theme parks and resorts worldwide. Having helped to create a new genre of film at Pixar, Lasseter returned to Disney on his own terms, despite having briefly worked there earlier in his career.

F When Iger invited Lasseter to speak at the 2006 shareholders' meeting, he was greeted with enthusiastic applause accompanied by a few bars of the Toy Story theme music. Lasseter spoke about his childhood love of Bugs Bunny cartoons and described working as a ride operator on Disneyland's Jungle Cruise, where telling jokes helped him gain confidence in public speaking. He also recalled studying at the California Institute of the Arts and the frustration he felt when Disney initially rejected computer animation technology. He concluded by explaining how he followed his dream to work with Ed Catmull.

G Dr Edwin Catmull, then sixty-one years old and president of Pixar, was seated among the shareholders. Originally a computer graphics researcher, Catmull had moved unexpectedly into business leadership. He was widely regarded as brilliant, yet known for listening rather than dominating conversations, and when he spoke his manner was consistently friendly and courteous.

H Although Catmull built on the work of others, the revolution in three-dimensional animation was largely his achievement. He maintained a long-term vision of fully computer-animated films and, while leading computer graphics laboratories at the New York Institute of Technology and at George Lucas's Lucasfilm, assembled the technical and creative teams that would later form the core of Pixar Animation Studios.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 Robert Iger had a low opinion of Michael D. Eisner.

2 Pixar Inc. had extremely limited financial success in its early years.

3 There were difficulties during the production of the film Toy Story.

4 In the early 1990s, Hollywood commentators were convinced animated films had a promising future.

5 Finding Nemo was more popular than Toy Story.

6 In 2004, Pixar contributed little to Disney's income from its film operations.

Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Lasseter and Catmull — A Professional Success Story

JOHN LASSETER

- was keen on watching Bugs Bunny cartoons when he was a schoolboy
- worked as a ride 7 ——— at Disneyland which increased his 8 ———
- attended California Institute of the Arts
- suffered 9 ——— over rejection of new technology by Disney studio

ED CATMULL

- was Pixar's 10 ——— at time of shareholder meeting in 2006
- preferred 11 ——— to taking control of conversations
- did not let go of his 12 ——— for computer animated films
- ran various computer graphics laboratories
- brought together the various teams on which the 13 ——— of Pixar would be founded

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Reading Passage 2

A Mechanical Friend for Children

A The development of robots that interact socially with people and assist them in everyday life has been an elusive goal of modern science. Despite impressive advances in the mechanical aspects of this problem, producing robots that bond and socialize with people for sustained periods of time has proven difficult. The most successful robots so far have been storytellers, but they have only been able to maintain human interest for a limited time and typically rely on the robot telling stories that change over time. In practice, commercially available robots seldom cross the 10-hour barrier (i.e. individual users tend to spend less than a combined total of 10 hours with the robots before losing interest). This observation is in sharp contrast to the long-term interactions and bonding that commonly develop between humans and their pets.

B In a recent study, researchers from the Institute for Neural Computation in California introduced a state-of-the-art social robot into a classroom of 18- to 24-month-olds for five months as a way of studying human/robot interactions. The researchers, including Fumihide Tanaka and Javier R Movellan, introduced a toddler-sized humanoid robot into a classroom at a childhood education center. One of the QRIO series of robots, the 58cm machine, was originally developed by Sony. Children of toddler age were chosen because they have no preconceived notions of robots, according to Tanaka. One of the goals of the study was to establish whether it was possible for social robots to maintain the interest of children beyond the 10-hour barrier.

C The researchers sent instructions to the robot about every two minutes to do things like giggle, dance, sit down, fall down or walk in a certain direction. The 45 sessions were videotaped, and interactions between toddlers and the robot were later analyzed. The results showed that the quality of those interactions improved steadily over 27 sessions. The interactions deteriorated quickly over the next 15 sessions, when the robot was ordered to behave in a more limited, predictable manner. Finally, the human/robot relations improved in the last three sessions, after the robot had been instructed to display its full range of behaviors.

D 'Initially the children treated the robot very differently from the way they treated each other,' Tanaka said. 'Early in the study some children cried when QRIO fell. But a month into the study, the toddlers helped QRIO stand up by pushing its back or pulling its hands.' The most important aspect of interaction was touch, Tanaka said. At first the toddlers would touch the robot on its face, but later on they would touch it only on its hands and arms, like they would with other humans. Another robot-like toy named Robby, which resembled QRIO but did not move, was used as a control in the study. While hugging of

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QRIO increased, hugging of Robby decreased throughout the study. Furthermore, when QRIO laid down on the floor as its batteries ran down, a toddler would put a blanket over his silver-colored 'friend' and say 'night-night'. Care-taking behaviors were frequently observed toward QRIO but seldom toward Robby.

E The study concluded that after 45 days of immersion in a childcare center over a period of five months, long-term bonding and socialization occurred between toddlers and a state-of-the-art social robot. Overall, the interaction between children and the robot improved over time and the children progressively treated it more as a peer than a plaything. 'To my knowledge, this is the first long-term study of this sort,' said Ronald Arkin, a roboticist at the Georgia Institute of Technology in the US.

F Tanaka and Movellan are now developing autonomous robots for the toddler classroom. 'It could have great potential in educational settings assisting teachers and enriching the classroom environment,' Tanaka said. The researchers hope that more advanced versions of robots like QRIO could become personalized tutors to assist teachers in classrooms. A robotic tutor could react on the spot to social cues and approximate social skills like facial expression and eye gaze, they said. 'It is becoming clear that, to achieve this goal, we are going to [need to] endow machines with something similar to emotion, not just traditional forms of intelligence,' said Movellan.

G Associate professor David Powers, an expert in artificial intelligence and cognitive science at Flinders University in South Australia, commented, 'In this study it is clearly demonstrated that limited range of robot behaviors, however impressive, is nowhere near as important to human/robot interaction as being able to make appropriate responses from a broad repertoire of behaviors'. Ronald Arkin was not surprised by the affection demonstrated by the toddlers toward the robot. 'Humans have a tremendous propensity to bond with artifacts, whether it be a car, a doll, or a robot,' he said. But he also cautioned that researchers do not yet understand the consequences of increased human/robot interaction. 'Studying how robots and humans work together can give us insight into whether this is a good thing or a bad thing for society,' Arkin said. 'We need to find out what the consequences are of introducing a robot into a cadre of children. How will that enhance, or potentially interfere with, their social development? Do we really understand the long-term impact of having a robot as a childhood friend?'

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Questions 14–18

Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, **A–G**.

Q	Statement	Answer
14	a comparison of children's reactions towards different robots	
15	a speculation about ways robots may be able to communicate	
16	a description of changes in the way the children physically handled a robot	
17	a comparison between people's connections with animals and their connections with robots	
18	an account of the way one robot was programmed	

Questions 19–23

Match each statement with the correct person, **A–D**.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Fumihide Tanaka

B Javier R. Movellan

C Ronald Arkin

D David Powers

Q	Statement	Answer
19	In future, robots will not only have to think, but also to show feelings.	
20	It is uncertain whether more contact between people and robots will be beneficial.	
21	Very young children have not yet developed ideas about robots.	
22	Robots need to perform a wide variety of actions for people to relate to them.	
23	Using robots as an aid in schools may have many benefits.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Until recently, robots that were best at holding people's attention were those that acted as (24) _____

The children responded to the QRIO robot as a friend or (25) _____ rather than as a toy.

Arkin expected that the children would show (26) _____ towards the QRIO robot.

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Reading Passage 3

The Peopling of Patagonia

A The human settlement of the southern extremity of the Americas has always fascinated pre-historians. Viewed from a global perspective, this was the last major continental land mass to be reached by human beings. The earliest occupation of Patagonia carries obvious implications for understanding when the North and South American continents were peopled, because it gives a baseline that all calculations regarding the rate of dispersion of humans throughout both continents must take into account.

B For many years the human settlement of North and South America has been conceived of as beginning in the far north and travelling progressively southwards to Patagonia. However, fundamental disagreements developed concerning the length of time involved. Some scholars accepted a human presence in the Americas as early as 20,000 years ago, while others proposed that it could date no earlier than 8,000 years ago, and the debate is still with us today.

C The idea of a relatively 'late' settlement of the Americas (around 8,000 years ago) implies that a rapid process of migration took place. Herein lies a second debate which revolves around the question of how migration is to be understood. The 'late' model demands a hypothetical migration conceived of as a single continually advancing wave of settlement. This has always been difficult to take seriously and many scholars now support the idea of an 'early' model that sees the migration as a less ordered migration, and this is surely the most realistic scenario as migrants slowly adapted to the diverse natural habitats they would have met while travelling through the continent.

D Those who argue for an earlier settlement, however, must contend with the lack of unequivocal evidence for archaeological sites older than around 14,000 years. Nevertheless, evidence for human occupation of the centre of South America is now securely dated to around 12,500 years ago at the Monte Verde site, which casts doubt on the 'late' model. The lack of archaeological evidence further south for this time period may be explained by the obstacle to humans on foot posed by the huge glacial streams that were present at that time.

E We can speculate then that the retreat of the Patagonian glaciers around 14,000 years ago allowed the initial human intrusion into a pristine environment, which was similar to that of early post-glacial Europe. Human settlement of the vast horizontal expanse of treeless high country must have been tenuous at best, and the evidence for this occupation remains relatively scant, most of it coming from rock shelters in Argentina and Chile. There is, however, reliable evidence from these sites to confirm the presence of humans by around 11,000 years ago in different habitats and some hints of an even older occupation.

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However, some other sites where evidence for even earlier human occupation was initially posited, have recently come under fresh scrutiny. This is because anthropologists have come to recognise that bones or other evidence may be deposited in caves by natural agency, in other words by other forces such as floods or predators, and not necessarily by humans.

F We shall turn now to a more detailed discussion of the archaeological evidence found in various parts of Patagonia. At the site located beside Chinchihuapi Creek, excavations have produced convincing evidence of human occupation, including hut foundations and wooden artefacts. They were buried in layers of peat, which has the property of preserving wood remarkably well, and as a result radiocarbon dating tests have shown these artefacts to date from around 12,500 years ago. One of the most famous Patagonian sites is a cave known as Los Toldos. However, the evidence from this site has recently been called into question, because dispersed flecks of carbon used in the test process were taken unsystematically from many different places in the site. As a result, the association of this material with the artefacts is not at all clear. About 150 kilometres south is the site called El Ceibo, where a similar collection of artefacts to that found at Los Toldos has been discovered from the lowest levels of the dig, but as yet no radiocarbon dates are available and this sort of analysis of the existing evidence is required before the site's value can be confirmed.

G The Arroyo Feo site is located very close to the high plateau. The artefacts from the earliest occupations were found at the same depth and have the same origins as those from Los Toldos, and have been securely dated to around 9,000 years ago. Another site that is mentioned in the debate is at Las Buitreras, where a number of stone flakes associated with bone remains of various animals have been discovered. However, anthropologists now believe that presumed cut marks on the bones are somewhat dubious, and despite detailed testing there is no way of securely relating any of these remains with human occupation. Finally some 50 kilometres to the south is the site at Cueva Fell, which was the first Patagonian site to be systematically studied by modern archaeological methods. However, it is now recognised that the utility of this site must be restricted to its direct vicinity, given changes to the nearby area caused by flooding, and findings cannot be freely extrapolated further afield.

H In conclusion, based on the evidence from a number of reliable sites, it seems probable that human populations reached Patagonia around 11,000 years ago.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct answer.

27 In the first paragraph, what is the writer's main point about migration to Patagonia?

A It started earlier than previously thought.
B Historians have overlooked its importance.
C It impacts on research into the wider region.
D Researchers have calculated its effects on the environment.

28 In the second paragraph, what is the writer's purpose?

A to challenge previous research
B to propose new areas to investigate
C to summarise a scholarly debate
D to suggest reasons for human migration

29 The writer refers to the 'late' model in order to

A compare it with another theory of migration.
B evaluate the success of American migration.
C criticise the speed of research into migration.
D compare migration in different parts of the world.

30 What is the writer's main point about the 'early' model?

A Scholars support the idea of fast migrations.
B It is too random to be convincing theory.
C South America was more habitable at an earlier time.
D It is more consistent with the physical conditions of the land.

31 What does the writer suggest about the Monte Verde site?

A It is much younger than researchers once estimated.
B It provides supporting evidence for relatively early settlement.
C Archaeologists believe the site is of questionable value.
D Streams exposed the site, making new research possible.

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Questions 32–35

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

32 The first settlers encountered conditions found nowhere else in the world.

33 Early settlers in highland areas relied mainly on hunting.

34 Archaeologists have drawn no conclusions from rock-shelter evidence.

35 Archaeological material can be relocated by natural processes.

Questions 36–40

Complete the summary below using the list of words, **A–J**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS

A Fixed date **B** random collection **C** similar properties
D good condition **E** scientific evaluation **F** huge quantities
G new samples **H** reliable connection **I** skilled preservation **J** immediate surroundings

The Archaeological Evidence from Patagonia

Building remains and other evidence have been found in 36 ———— at the Chinchihuapi Creek site, and because of this it has been possible to date them at around 12,500 years ago. However, the 37 ———— of the sample taken from Los Toldos means that this site is of doubtful value. El Ceibo is a more promising dig, where the examination of artefacts would be beneficial in order to confirm the usefulness of discoveries there. The remains found at the Arroyo Feo site show 38 ———— and date from around 9,000 years ago. Unfortunately, no 39 ———— connection can be made between the samples taken from Las Buitreras and human presence. The findings of the work carried out at Cueva Fell cannot provide useful information beyond the 40 ———— immediate area. In conclusion, though the evidence is mixed, it is believed that human population of Patagonia began about 11,000 years ago.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 5

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Western Immigration of Canada

A By the mid-1870s Canada wanted an immigrant population of agricultural settlers established in the West. No urban centres existed on the prairies in the 1870s, and rural settlement was the focus of the federal government's attention. The western rural settlement was desired, as it would provide homesteads for the sons and daughters of eastern farmers, as eastern agricultural land filled to capacity. As well, eastern farmers and politicians viewed western Canada, with its broad expanses of unpopulated land, as a prime location for expanding Canada's agricultural output, especially in terms of wheat production to serve the markets of eastern Canada.

B To bolster Canada's population and agricultural output, the federal government took steps to secure western land. The Dominion of Canada purchased Rupert's Land from the Hudson's Bay Company in 1870. In 1872, the federal government enacted the Dominion Lands Act. This act enabled settlers to acquire 160 acres of free land, as long as settlers remained on their land for a period of three years, made certain minor improvements to the land, and paid a $10.00 registration fee. The Canadian government also created a Mounted Police Force in 1873. The Mounties journeyed west to secure the area for future settlers. By 1876 the NWMP had established themselves in the West. The major posts included Swan River, Fort Saskatchewan, Fort Calgary, Fort Walsh and Fort Macleod. All of these initiatives attracted a number of Eastern-Canadian settlers, as well as European and American immigrants, to Canada's West, and particularly to the area of Manitoba.

C The surest way to protect Canadian territory, and to achieve the secondary goal for joining British Columbia to the rest of the country, was to import large numbers of Eastern Canadian and British settlers. Settling the West also made imperative the building of a transcontinental railway. The railway would work to create an east-west economy, in which western Canada would feed the growing urban industrial population of the east, and in return become a market for eastern Canadian manufactured goods.

D Winnipeg became the metropolis of the West during this period. Winnipeg's growth before 1900 was the result of a combination of land speculation, growth of housing starts, and the federal government's solution in 1881 of Winnipeg as a major stop along the CPR. This decision culminated in a land boom between 1881 and 1883 which resulted in the transformation of hamlets like Portage la Prairie and Brandon into towns, and a large

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increase in Manitoba's population. Soon, Winnipeg stood at the junction of three transcontinental railway lines which employed thousands in rail yards. Winnipeg also became the major processor of agricultural products for the surrounding hinterland.

E The majority of settlers to Winnipeg, and the surrounding countryside, during this early period, were primarily Protestant English-speaking settlers from Ontario and the British Isles. These settlers established Winnipeg upon a British-Ontarian ethos which came to dominate the society's social, political, and economic spirit. This British-Ontarian ethnic homogeneity, however, did not last very long. Increasing numbers of foreign immigrants, especially from Austria-Hungary and Ukraine soon added a new ethnic element to the recent British, the older First Nation Métis, and Selkirk's settler population base. Settling the West with (in particular) Eastern Canadians and British immigrants offered the advantage of safeguarding the 49th parallel from the threat of American take-over, had not the Minnesota legislature passed a resolution which provided for the annexation of the Red River district. The Red River in 1870 was the most important settlement on the Canadian prairies. It contained 11,963 inhabitants of whom 9,700 were Métis and First Nations. But neighbouring Minnesota already had a population of over 100,000.

F Not all of the settlers who came to western Canada in the 1880s, however, desired to remain there. In the 1870s and 1880s, economic depression kept the value of Canada's staple exports low, which discouraged many from permanent settlement in the West. Countries including Brazil, Argentina, Australia, New Zealand and the United States competed with Canada for immigrants. Many immigrants and thousands of Canadians chose to settle in the accessible and attractive American frontier. Canada before 1891 has been called "a huge demographic railway station" where thousands of men, women, and children were constantly going and coming, and where the number of departures invariably exceeded that of arrivals.

G By 1891 Eastern Canada had its share of both large urban centres and problems associated with city life. While the booming economic centres of Toronto and Montreal were complete with electricity and telephones in the cities' wealthiest areas by the turn of the century, slum conditions characterised the poorest areas like the district known as 'the Ward' in Toronto. Chickens and pigs ran through the streets; privy buckets spilled onto backyards and lanes creating cesspools in urban slums. These same social reformers believed that rural living, in stark contrast to urban, would lead to a healthy, moral, and charitable way of life. Social reformers praised the ability of fresh air, hard work, and open spaces for 'Canadianizing' immigrants. Agricultural pursuits were seen as especially fitting for attaining this 'moral' and family-oriented way of life, in opposition to the single male-dominated atmosphere of the cities. Certainly, agriculture played an important part in the Canadian economy in 1891. One-third of the workforce worked on farms.

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H The Canadian government presented Canada's attractions to potential overseas migrants in several ways. The government offered free or cheap land to potential agriculturists. As well, the government established agents and/or agencies for the purpose of attracting emigrants overseas. Assisted passage schemes, bonuses and commissions to agents and settlers and pamphlets also attracted some immigrants to Canada. The most influential form of attracting others to Canada, however, remained the letters home written by emigrants already in Canada. Letters from trusted friends and family members. Letters home often contained exaggerations of the 'wonder of the new world.' Migrant workers and settlers already in Canada did not want to disappoint, or worry, their family and friends at home. Embellished tales of good fortune and happiness often succeeded in encouraging others to come.

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Questions 1–7

Reading Passage 1 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Choose the correct heading for paragraphs A, B, C, D, E, F and H from the list of headings below. NB One paragraph does not need a heading.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Not all would stay in Canada forever
ii Government's safeguard in the West
iii Eastern Canada is full
iv Built-up to the new infrastructure
v An exclusive British domination in Ontario established ever since
vi Ethnic and language make-up
vii Pursuing a pure life
viii Police recruited from mid-class families
x Early major urban development of the West
xi Attracting urban environment
xii Advertising of Western Canada

Q	Paragraph	Answer
1	Paragraph A	
2	Paragraph B	
3	Paragraph C	
4	Paragraph D	
5	Paragraph E	
6	Paragraph F	
7	Paragraph H	

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Questions 8–13

Complete the summary below. Use **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

With the saturation of Eastern Canada, the Western rural area would supply (8) _____ for the descendants of easterners. Politicians also declared that Western has got potential to increase (9) _____ of Canada according to (10) _____ crop that consumed in the East. The federal government started to prepare and made it happen. First, the government bought land from a private (11) _____ and legally offered a certain area to people who stayed for a qualifying period of time. Then, mounted (12) _____ was found to secure the land. However, the best way to protect citizens was to build a (13) _____ to transport the migrants and goods between the West and the East.

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Reading Passage 2

Why Don't We Sleep?

A Fifty-six million prescriptions for sleeping medication were handed out by doctors in America last year. Yet remarkably little is being done to understand insomnia's root causes. Socially and economically, the undertreatment of sleeplessness is hugely expensive. The Institute of Medicine, an independent scientific advisory group, estimates nearly 20 percent of all major accidents on the road are associated with driver sleepiness. The loss in terms of productivity within the workplace is even higher, costing billions. Then there are the softer costs which remain unmeasured but still exist; for example, the damaged relationships with others. If other medical problems were causing such widespread harm, governments would act, but US authorities contribute only about $230 million a year for the funding of sleep research, comparable to the amount that the manufacturers of popular sleeping pills spent in three months on advertising. Currently most medical school students get no more than four hours of training on sleep disorders; some get none.

B If we don't know why we can't sleep, it's in part because we don't really know why we need to sleep in the first place. We know that we divide it between periods of deep-wave sleep and rapid eye movement (REM) sleep, when the brain is as active as when we're awake, but our voluntary muscles are paralyzed. We know that all mammals sleep, and that there are some insects and reptiles that only half sleep, in order to remain aware of their environment and predators.

C The predominant theory of sleep is that the brain demands it. Recently, researchers at Harvard, led by Robert Stickgold, tested undergraduates on various aptitude tests, allowed them to nap, then tested them again. They found that those who had engaged in REM sleep subsequently performed better in pattern recognition tasks, such as grammar, while those who slept deeply were better at memorization.

D Such studies suggest that memory consolidation may be one function of sleep. Giulio Tononi, a sleep researcher at the University of Wisconsin, published an interesting twist on this theory a few years ago. His study showed that the sleeping brain seems to delete redundant or unnecessary synapses or connections. So the purpose of sleep may be to help us remember what's important, by letting us forget what's not.

E Sleep is likely to have physiological purposes too. Some researchers have found that sleep deprivation impedes wound healing in rats, and others have suggested that sleep helps boost the immune system and control infection. But these studies are not conclusive. At Stanford University, William Dement, co-founder of the Stanford Sleep Medicine

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Center, explains what he knows after 50 years of research, about the reason we sleep. 'As far as I know,' he said, 'the only reason we need to sleep that is really, really solid is because we get sleepy.'

F The Stanford clinic does more than 3,000 overnight sleep studies a year. Their main diagnostic tool is the polysomnogram, the main element of which is the electroencephalograph (EEG), which captures the electrical output from a patient's brain. As the EEG records a person's sleep patterns, the polysomnogram technicians also measure body temperature, muscle activity, eye movement, and breathing. Then they look over the data for signs of abnormal sleep. When a person has narcolepsy, for instance, they plunge from wakefulness into REM sleep without any intermediate steps. However, Clete Kushida, the clinic director, told me he can spot most people's sleep problems right at the intake interview. 'There are those who cannot keep their eyes open, and those who just speak of their exhaustion but don't actually fall asleep. The former often have sleep apnea where they stop breathing. The latter have true insomnia.'

G In sleep apnea, muscle relaxation allows the soft tissue of the throat to close, shutting off the sleeper's air passage. When the brain realizes it is not getting oxygen, it sends a signal to the body to wake up. The sleeper awakes, inhales, and sleep returns. Apnea is a serious problem but only indirectly a sleep disease. True insomniacs are people who either can't get to, or can't stay asleep for any evident reason.

H While apnea can be treated with a device that forces air down the sleeper's throat to keep the airways open, the treatment of classic insomnia is not so clear cut. Acupuncture may help. It has long had this role in Asian medicine and is being studied at the University of Pittsburgh sleep center now. Typically in the US, insomnia is treated in two ways. First come the sleeping pills. Though safer than they once were, they can still lead to psychological addiction. 'Many users complain that their sleeping-pill sleep seems different, and they feel unfocussed on waking. Sleeping pills are not a natural way to sleep,' points out Charles Czeisler, director of the Harvard Health and Safety Group.

I The second step in treating insomniacs is usually cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT). In CBT, a psychologist teaches insomniacs to think about sleep problems as manageable, and to practice good 'sleep hygiene': sleep in a dark room, go to bed only when you are sleepy, don't exercise beforehand. Studies have shown that CBT is more effective than sleeping pills at treating long-term insomnia, but many sufferers aren't convinced. 'Some people continue in my experience to struggle,' says John Winkelman, another sleep center director. 'They're not super-satisfied with their sleep.'

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Questions 14–17

Complete the summary below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *for each answer.*

Last year the high number of (14) ———————— doctors gave their patients highlights the fact that insomnia is a serious issue in the USA. It is evidently responsible for a number of serious traffic (15) ———————— and has a considerable effect on company (16) ————————. A lack of sleep can also have a harmful effect on different relationships, although there are no statistics on this. Unfortunately, there is insufficient official funding given to research into sleep problems, and the (17) ———————— given at medical school is also insufficient to deal with insomnia.

Questions 18–23

Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, **A–I**.

Q	Statement	Answer
18	a mention of different cultural approaches to dealing with insomnia	
19	indications that sleep has a positive effect on health	
20	the effects of different kinds of sleep on mental performance	
21	reasons why various species of animal sleep in different ways	
22	the suggestion that sleep allows us to get rid of insignificant information	
23	a description of how the brain responds when a person stops breathing	

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Questions 24–26

Match each statement with the correct person, **A–E**.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Giulio Tononi

B William Dement

C Clete Kushida

D Charles Czeisler

E John Winkelman

Q	Statement	Answer
24	Research tells us that we sleep as reaction to our body's signals.	
25	People suffering from insomnia are easily recognisable.	
26	Therapy does not always enable people to achieve good quality sleep.	

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Reading Passage 3

Understanding Symbols

Judy DeLoache describes her research into the difficulties children experience with symbols

A About 20 years ago I had one of those wonderful moments when research takes an unexpected but fruitful turn. I had been studying toddler memory and was beginning a new experiment with two-and-a-half- and three-year-olds. For the project, I had built a model of a room that was in my laboratory. The real space contained basic furniture such as a couch and table. The miniature version was as similar as possible to its larger counterpart: the furniture was the same shape and material and was arranged in the same position. For the study, a child watched as we hid a miniature toy - a plastic dog we called Little Snoopy in the model. We then encouraged the child to find 'Big Snoopy', a large version of the toy 'hiding in the same place in his big room.'

B The three-year-olds were very successful. After they observed the small toy being placed behind the miniature couch, they ran into the room and found the large toy behind the real couch. But the two-and-a-half-year-olds failed abysmally. They cheerfully ran into the room to retrieve the large toy, but most had no idea where to look, even though they remembered where the tiny toy was hidden in the miniature room and could readily find it there.

C Their failure to use what they knew about the model to draw an inference about the real room indicated that they did not appreciate the relation between the model and the room. I realised my memory study was instead a study of symbolic understanding and that the children's failure might be telling us something about how and when children acquire the ability to understand that one object stands for another.

D The first type of symbolic object that infants and young children master is the picture. No symbols seem simpler to adults, but infants initially find pictures perplexing. The problem stems from the duality inherent in all symbolic objects: they are real in themselves and also representations of something else. A few years ago I became intrigued by anecdotes suggesting that infants do not appreciate this duality-stories of a baby trying to pick up a depicted toy or fit a foot into a photograph of a shoe. We assumed such behaviour would be rare and therefore difficult to study.

E Fortunately we were wrong. We began testing infants' understanding of pictures by putting a book of highly realistic colour photographs of individual objects in front of nine-month-olds. To our surprise, every child in the study reached out to feel or scratch the pictures. The confusion seems to be conceptual not perceptual. Infants can perfectly well perceive the difference between objects and pictures and given the choice they will choose the real thing. But they do not yet fully understand what pictures are and how they differ

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from real objects. However, when depicted objects bear little resemblance to the real thing as in a black and white drawing - infants rarely explore them. By 18 months, babies have come to appreciate that a picture merely represents an object; instead of manipulating the paper, they point to pictures and name objects. Nevertheless, it takes several years for the nature of pictures to be completely understood.

F Studies have shown that, until the age of four, many children think that turning a picture of a bowl of popcorn upside down will result in the depicted popcorn falling out of the bowl.

G Pictures are not the only source of confusion for very young children. In a third experiment, we brought a group of toddlers (18-to 30-month-old children) Into a room containing a child's slide, a chair, and a toddler-sized car. The children played with these for a while. Then we secretly replaced each object with an identical miniature version. Most children attempted to perform the same actions with the miniature items that they had with the larger ones. Some tried to sit on the chair, others attempted to climb into the car. Interestingly, most of the children showed little or no reaction to their failed attempts. We think this probably reflects the fact that toddlers' daily lives are full of unsuccessful attempts to do one thing or another.

H This confusion has implications for educational practice. Teachers everywhere use blocks or other objects to represent numerical quantity. However, if young children do not understand the relation between an object and what it represents, this could be counterproductive. To demonstrate this, we taught six-and seven-year-olds a difficult subtraction problem using blocks. We taught an identical comparison group the same concept, but using pencil and paper. Both groups learned to solve the problems equally well, but the group using blocks took three times as long to do so.

I Dual representation also comes into play in many children's books. Modern children's books are often 3D, with features that encourage children to interact directly with the book itself, for example flaps that can be lifted to reveal pictures. Graduate student Cynthia Chong and I reasoned that these features might distract children from the information. Accordingly, we used different types of books to teach letters to 30-month-old children. One was a simple old-fashioned alphabet book with each letter accompanied by an appropriate picture. The other was a 3-D version. The children using the traditional book subsequently recognised more letters than those using the 3-D book.

J Presumably, the children could concentrate more easily with the plain 2-D book, whereas with the other one they were distracted by the 3-D activities. Less may be more when it comes to educational books for young children.

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Questions 27–32

Choose the correct answer.

27 In the first paragraph, what did the children in the experiment have to do?

A spot the differences between a real room and a smaller version
B make a copy of a life-sized room using small furniture
C hide a large toy in a tiny room
D locate a toy in a life-sized room

28 What was the result of the first experiment?

A Both two-and-a-half-and three-year-olds completed the task successfully.
B Three-year-olds could mentally relate the two rooms they had been shown.
C Two-and-a-half-year-olds could relate more closely to the toys as symbols.
D Two-and-a-half-year-olds had poorer memory than three-year-olds.

29 In the fourth paragraph, what does the writer say about children and pictures?

A Infants are unable to understand that pictures serve a double purpose.
B Young children may understand pictures more readily than adults.
C Infants can understand that a picture of food cannot be eaten.
D Adults should encourage children to look at pictures from an early age.

30 In the third experiment, what did the writer notice about the reactions of the toddlers?

A They often behaved in an unpredictable way.
B They were only comfortable performing very familiar tasks.
C They became frustrated when they could not achieve a task.
D They behaved the same whether they were successful or not.

31 What did the experiment involving a mathematical problem suggest about children's learning?

A Children are able to understand complex concepts at an early age.
B Children younger than seven cannot learn using pencil and paper alone.
C Using blocks can make it harder for children to learn new concepts.
D Teachers should try using blocks to teach mathematics to lower level students.

32 What does DeLoache conclude about the results of her and Chong's experiment?

A Children's books should be more interactive.
B 2-D books should contain realistic images.
C Simpler books may be better learning tools.
D 3-D books help weaker students to progress.

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Questions 33–35

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, *below.*

LIST OF ENDINGS

A that a three-year-old may still expect an image to perform a real task.

B how quickly children can learn the alphabet.

C the best age for children to begin school.

D the effectiveness of symbolic objects as teaching tools.

E whether young children are puzzled by pictures.

F that young children expect tiny objects to function in the same way as life-sized ones.

Q	Sentence	Answer
33	The test involving 9-month-old babies attempted to find out ____	
34	The third experiment revealed ____	
35	The maths experiment was designed to assess ____	

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

36 The results of the first experiment revealed unexpected information.

37 Infants react the same way to both drawings and photographs.

38 Toddlers are used to failing in many of the tasks they try to perform.

39 The confusion of symbols and real objects has little significance for educational practice.

40 Children enjoy reading 3-D books more than 2-D books.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 6

Volume 8 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Optimism and Health

If you have a positive outlook, the likelihood is that you will lead a longer life. John Nash examines the link between optimism and good health.

A Medical studies are concluding that optimists really do have something to be cheerful about. Coincidental links between optimism and improved general health have been found by researchers. Recently, a Yale University psychologists' study of 660 volunteers aged 50 and above was published. It found that thinking positively about ageing adds an average of seven years to a person's life. The team, led by Dr Becca Levy, suggests that having an optimistic attitude can bolster the will to live, though they admit that they cannot explain it fully.

B Another American research team, however, says they have identified a physical mechanism behind the phenomenon. Their eight-year study of 670 men aged about 63 found that the optimists had significantly better lung function than men who were more pessimistic. This is the first study to show such a link. The research team at Brigham & Women's Hospital and Harvard Medical School believes that attitude somehow strengthens the immune system, and that adopting a more positive outlook may reverse physical decline. 'Preliminary studies on heart patients suggest that by changing a person's outlook, you can improve their mortality risk,' says Dr Rosalind Wright.

C The role of optimism in good health has long been noted but often sidelined. Sigmund Freud, the influential psychologist, linked optimism with ignorance, and from 1970 to 2000 there were 46,000 psychology papers on depression and only 40 on joy. Part of that negativity may be blamed on optimists themselves. They are not necessarily fun to have around, says Brice Pitt, the Emeritus Professor of the Psychiatry of Old Age at Imperial College, London. 'Optimists tend to be insufferable people. Always jolly, always up, and, frankly, they have a hopelessly rosy outlook' he says. 'Depressive people see things as they really are, and that is a disadvantage from an evolutionary point of view. Optimism is a piece of evolutionary equipment that has carried us a long way through millennia of setbacks.'

D Studies show that optimists do better than pessimists in work, school and sports: suffer less depression, achieve more goals, respond better to stress and fight disease better. Among people aged from their mid-nineties into their hundreds, researchers generally fail

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to find consistencies in diet or exercise (and some still smoke). What the super-aged do tend to share, however, is a positive, optimistic outlook. Toshihiko Maruta, of the Mayo Institute, headed an earlier American medical study to find a link between optimism and longevity. Her study found that optimists live about 19 per cent longer than people with grim outlooks. 'It tells us that mind and body are linked and that attitude has an impact on the final outcome: death,' she says. That simple message might have far more effect than exhortations to eat fresh fruit and warnings to stay out of the sun.

E Despite the benefits of unprecedented material wealth, the World Health Organisation estimates that depression is soon to become the second leading cause of disability. Popular wisdom blames this on our frenetically busy society. According to social forecasters at the Henley Centre, while people in developed countries are 65 per cent better off financially today than they were 15 years ago, there is no evidence that they are any more content with their lives. While much of this is down to the perception among many of being rushed and pressured for time and space, it is the perception not the reality that counts, they say. The Henley researchers found that if people think they have enough time, space or money, they feel more relaxed about life, regardless of how much of these things they actually have. 'In terms of money, some of the people who "feel" wealthiest, and some of those who "feel" poorest, actually have almost the same amount of money at their disposal. Their attitudes and behaviour patterns, however, are different from one another,' says Chad Wallens, a researcher.

F Few studies have tried to ascertain the proportion of optimists in the world. But a 1995 nationwide survey conducted in the USA for the American magazine Adweek found that about half the population counted themselves as optimists, with women slightly more apt than men (53 per cent versus 48 per cent) to identify themselves thus. That attitude drops, however, to less than a third of people between the ages of 55 and 64, which supports research showing that men, in particular, tend to become more irritable as they get older. Lynn Myers, a psychotherapist, points out, however, that too much optimism can be a bad thing: 'You can be what is called a cock-eyed optimist, the sort of person who smokes but is convinced they will never get lung cancer.' Curiously, though, the Brigham & Women's Hospital study found that optimism was linked to improved lung function even after smoking was taken into account.

G Myers is sceptical about whether there is a simple way that people can become optimistic in order to improve their health chances. 'I certainly would not suggest that there is anything like "six easy lessons to change your outlook.' But if you can lower your anxiety levels, it tends to make you more optimistic. Conversely, people who are highly anxious tend to be pessimistic,' she says.

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Questions 1–5

Complete the summary below. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Studies at Yale University have shown that a positive attitude can lengthen someone's lifespan by approximately (1) ————————. Another US research team claims to have found a physical reason why this happens. As a result of an eight-year study on (2) ———————— male subjects of a certain age, they have noted differences in the (3) ———————— among positive and negative thinkers. This discovery has led them to conclude that positive thinking makes the body's entire (4) ———————— stronger, which, in turn, reduces ageing. Rosalind Wright cites some early research on (5) ———————— in support of this view.

Questions 6–10

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–H**, *below.*

LIST OF ENDINGS

A Optimists have an unrealistic view of life.
B long life is also linked to diet and exercise.
C excessive optimism may have negative consequences.
D optimism has not been considered a worthy research topic.
E a hectic lifestyle can lead to poor health.
F happiness is not linked to material comfort.
G levels of optimism can decrease with age.
H optimists can have a positive effect on pessimists.

Q	Sentence	Answer
6	The writer's reference to Sigmund Freud illustrates the point that	
7	According to Brice Pitt of Imperial College, London,	
8	Researchers at the Henley Centre have shown that	
9	The 1995 Adweek Survey found that across the USA	
10	The psychotherapist Lynn Myers suggests that	

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Questions 11–13

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

11 It has been known for some time that there is a link between optimism and good health.

12 Optimists have better personal relationships with others than pessimists.

13 People who live to be over ninety-five are known to take the same amount of regular exercise.

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Reading Passage 2

New Technology in New Zealand's Health Service

A At some time in their lives, nearly all New Zealanders will have to attend an after-hours clinic following an emergency or accident. On entering the consulting room, the patient is faced with a barrage of questions. The first ones relate to the current episode, and are followed by more general enquiries. Do you have any allergies? Are you on any medications? And so on. But imagine a different scenario. The patient walks into the consulting room and there on the healthcare professional's computer screen is his or her medical record in its entirety — allergies, medications, test results and everything else. To some, it's amazing that this isn't happening already. After all, individuals can track their bank accounts, phone records and countless other transactions online, so why can't they track their health? Ian McCrae, Orion Health's CEO, says that it's understandable if health often falls behind other sectors in its adoption of information technology (IT). It might be, he argues, because of concerns about patient privacy, but also because health care is just so complicated.

B The irony is, New Zealand started out being ahead of the game. The backbone of any health IT system is having a unique identifier for each patient, and New Zealand's national health index (NHI) number system was introduced in 1993, before most other countries in the world. Innovation then slowed for some years, but in 2011 the earthquake in Canterbury, which affected thousands of people, was a catalyst for health IT in that region of the country. Suddenly, many people couldn't be seen by their usual doctor and many health records were inaccessible. An existing plan for an electronic shared record was fast-tracked, and within six months a basic system, HealthOne, was up and running. By 2013, clinicians in the hospital emergency department were able to see all relevant medical information about patients. Dr. Nigel Millar, Chief Medical Officer for the Canterbury region, says within days doctors were telling him the information had already revolutionised the way they worked.

C This idea, known as a 'patient portal', is now in operation in other parts of the country, including the capital Wellington. With a mobile app patients can remain connected to their patient portal on their mobile device, allowing for added flexibility. However, there's a lot of complacency in medicine, according to Dr. Richard Medlicott. He says that innovative IT systems have the potential to radically change health care delivery, because they will free doctors from routine administrative tasks and instead allow them to focus on diagnosis and patient care, which is where their skills are really needed. But he admits there is some way to go in the adoption of shared care records, and also in changing the mindset of some doctors who are resistant to change. A good example of technology in use

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comes from Australia, where the National Home Doctor Service has brought back a service that was becoming infrequent — the home visit. The after hours service uses an app to arrange an on-call doctor who will visit patients at home to provide on-the-spot healthcare.

D A key part of the health IT picture is maintaining a dialogue and exchange of ideas between healthcare professionals, according to Kate Reid, a director at Orion Health. Reid says this is critical, but it's not easy because there are so many different agencies that are sometimes in competition. Another issue, Reid says, is that there are many information systems that are being trialled today. However, these trials are not big enough to determine if they could ever work at a national level. One area where cooperation in health IT really could deliver benefits is in disease prevention and early intervention, says Reid. 'We've got innovations and technology that could be reaching at-risk people right now,' she argues, but the infrastructure is not in place to allow funding to be shifted from treatment to prevention. Scott Arrol, CEO of New Zealand Health IT, says that advances are coming, they're just not arriving as fast as everybody would like.

E While IT is extremely important to a functioning health system, there are other areas where New Zealand technologies are improving health care. Dr. Hong Sheng Chiong, for example, has adapted a smartphone camera for medical use. The examination kit combines a phone adapter and app, allowing users to examine the eye with minimal training. Another innovation is the Clever MedKit, an intelligent first aid kit. It separates different items like band-aids and ice packs and orders replacements when necessary, making it particularly helpful in today's busy offices. In a separate field, the use of pre-made ceramic fittings which can be placed over a broken tooth in a single sitting reduces the cost of treatment. Dr. Adam Doudney came up with the idea before it was developed by researchers at the technology company Rhondium. Another idea is the Silhouette system, which offers a way to easily monitor wounds. It allows practitioners to detect small differences in wound size by collecting accurate images and data. Finally, the Auckland Bioengineering Institute is helping those wishing to keep fit or rehabilitate from injury. When placed on the body their special sensor moves with the wearer and measures the amount of movement, before the data is transmitted to the user's mobile or tablet. It'll be fascinating to see how these and other technologies transform medicine over the years to come.

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Questions 14–18

Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, **A–E**.

Q	Statement	Answer
14	reference to a medical practice that became less common but is now being used more frequently in one country	
15	reference to a health management scheme in New Zealand that was more advanced than those used in other nations	
16	the claim that some of the information systems being tested in the health sector are only on a small scale	
17	reference to the fact that most people in New Zealand will experience an urgent medical situation at some point	
18	mention of a dramatic event that led to improved use of health information technology in one part of New Zealand	

Questions 19–22

Match each statement with the correct person, **A–E**. *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Ian McCrae
B Nigel Millar
C Richard Medlicott
D Kate Reid
E Scott Arrol

Q	Statement	Answer
19	Money should be invested in technology that attempts to stop people becoming sick, rather than caring for them once they are sick.	
20	There are good reasons why healthcare does not make more use of technology to manage patient information.	
21	Health professionals need to communicate and work together, even if they have different interests.	
22	New technologies will enable healthcare professionals to concentrate on the most important aspects of their work.	

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Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Apart from IT, New Zealand scientists have made good progress with other types of medical technology. Dr Chiong has designed a camera so that doctors can look into a patient's (23) ———— for use in (24) ————. Clever MedKit provides everyday medical supplies and ensures stocks are always up-to-date. Meanwhile, the cost of repairing a (25) ———— is likely to be reduced thanks to Dr Adam Doudney, whose idea was developed by researchers at Rhondium. Another breakthrough is that changes in the (26) ———— of wounds can now be recorded more accurately because of the new Silhouette system. Lastly, a new type of sensor developed by the Auckland Bioengineering Institute can assist fitness and recovery.

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Reading Passage 3

Game Theory

Computer software that models human behaviour can make forecasts, outsmart rivals, and transform negotiations

A According to game theory, our chances of success in negotiations are based on the choices of others. Computer models have been developed to work out how events will unfold as people and organizations act in what they perceive to be their own best interests. Numerical values are placed on the goals, motivations, and influence of players, and likely options are considered. Game theory software then evaluates the ability of each of those players to influence others, and hence predicts the course of events.

B Although many individuals would feel uncomfortable having a computer make decisions for them, many organizations run such computer simulations for law firms, companies, and governments. But feeding software with accurate data on all the players involved is especially tricky for political matters. Reinier van Oosten of Decide, a Dutch firm that models political negotiations, notes that predictions may become unreliable when people unexpectedly give in to 'non-rational' emotions such as hatred, rather than pursuing what is apparently in their best interests. However, sorting out people's motivations is much easier when making money is the main object. Accordingly, modeling behavior using game theory is proving especially useful when applied to economics.

C Using game theory software to model auctions can be very lucrative. Consulting firms are entering the market to help clients design profitable auctions, or to win them less expensively. In 2006, in the run-up to an online auction of radio-spectrum licenses by America's Federal Communications Commission, Dr Paul Milgrom, a consultant and Stanford University professor in the United States, customized his game theory software to assist a consortium of bidders. He was apprehensive at first, but the result was a triumph. When the auction began, Milgrom's software tracked competitors' bids to estimate their budgets for the 1,132 licenses on offer. Crucially, the software estimated the secret values bidders placed on specific licenses and determined that certain big licenses were being overvalued. Milgrom's clients were then directed to obtain a collection of smaller, less expensive licenses instead. Two of his clients paid about a third less than their competitors for an equivalent amount of spectrum, saving almost $1.2 billion. Such a saving makes one wonder why everyone isn't using game theory software. And, if they were, how would that affect the game?

D PA Consulting, a British firm, designs models for software based on game theory to help its clients solve specific problems in areas from pharmaceuticals to the production of television shows. British government agencies have asked PA Consulting to build models

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to test scenarios that address how many of a type of business should be allowed to operate in a particular area. A simple example: if two competing ice-cream sellers share a long beach, they will set up stalls back-to-back in the middle and stay put, explains Dr Stephen Black, a modeler for PA. Unfortunately for potential customers at the far ends of the beach, each seller prevents the other from relocating — no other spot would be closer to more people. Introduce a third seller, however, and the stifling equilibrium is broken as relocations and pricing changes energize the market. By studying a chain of events such as this, software designers can assess the effect of change and see the patterns in possible outcomes that may occur. As a result, the use of modeling makes clients more inclined to look at future repercussions when making business decisions, Black says.

E Where is all this heading? Alongside the increasingly elaborate modeling software, there are also efforts to develop software that can assist in negotiation and mediation. Two decades ago, Dr Clara Ponsati, a Spanish academic, came up with a clever idea. She accepted that, as negotiators everywhere know, the first side to disclose the maximum amount that it is willing to pay loses considerable bargaining power. Without leverage, it can be pushed backward in the bargaining process by a clever opponent. But if neither side reveals the concessions it is prepared to make, negotiations can become very slow or collapse. However, difficult negotiations can often be pushed along by neutral mediators, especially if they are entrusted with the secret bottom lines of all parties. Ponsati's idea was that if a human mediator was not trusted, affordable, or available, a computer could do the job instead. Negotiating parties would update the software with the confidential information on their bargaining positions after each round of talks. Once positions on both sides were no longer mutually exclusive, the software would be used to split the difference and propose an agreement. Ponsati, now head of the Institute of Economic Analysis at the Autonomous University of Barcelona in Spain, says such "mediation machines" could be employed to push negotiations forward by unlocking information that would otherwise be withheld from an opponent.

F Could mediation which has been achieved using software based on game theory spread from auction bids and utility pricing to resolving political and military disputes? Today's game theory software is not yet sufficiently advanced to mediate between warring countries. But one day opponents on the brink of war might be tempted to use it to exchange information without having to engage in conflict. According to some game theorists, opponents could learn how a war would turn out, skip the fighting, and strike a deal. Over-optimistic, perhaps — but game theorists do have rather an impressive track record when it comes to predicting the future.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct answer.

27 What does the writer suggest about game theory software in the first paragraph?

A Traditional negotiating practices should be used to supplement the software.
B Success of the software depends on the accuracy of the assigned values.
C This software anticipates the outcome of future events.
D Future business negotiations will be dominated by this software.

28 Reinier van Oosten says predicting what people will do works best if

A participants are honest about how they feel.
B there is a good understanding of the client's culture.
C people strongly dislike the other party.
D profit is the primary motivator.

29 After using game theory software in 2006, Dr Milgrom instructed his clients to

A buy big licenses.
B negotiate with the other parties directly.
C make one big offer at the end of the auction.
D purchase a mix of licenses.

30 The writer refers to Stephen Black's ice-cream seller example in order to

A show the impact new competitors have on business.
B highlight the importance of location on business success.
C demonstrate that businesses must follow a strategy.
D clarify how pricing affects sales.

31 Ponsati believes business negotiations are more likely to progress if

A a solution is proposed by one of the interested parties.
B mediators or computers take over the bargaining process.
C both parties follow the rules of negotiating.
D sufficient time is allowed for the bargaining process.

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Questions 32–35

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

32 Game theory software may be unhelpful when dealing with political issues.

33 Dr Milgrom was confident about applying his software to an auction in 2006.

34 Dr Ponsati believes 'mediation machines' are an inappropriate method of negotiation in areas other than business.

35 Military organizations refuse to accept that software based on game theory could prevent wars.

Questions 36–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F***, below.*

LIST OF ENDINGS

A something is thought to be worth more than it really is.
B discussions between the parties begin to break down.
C too much information is given to the other parties early on.
D businesses consider possible future developments.
E people allow their feelings to influence decisions.
F a solution requires face-to-face negotiation.

Q	Sentence	Answer
36	According to Reinier van Oosten, game theory software fails when	
37	Dr Milgrom's software is successful in detecting if	
38	Dr Black's game theory software is a helpful tool when	
39	According to Dr Ponsati, negotiators fall behind if	
40	Dr Ponsati's mediation machine is useful when	

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PART TWO

Answer Keys

Complete answer keys for Tests 1–6 of Volume 8. Check your answers only after finishing each test.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 1 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — Steam Across the Water

1. inefficient

QUESTION KEYWORD	engine was ____ due to weight
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a Newcomen engine, which was heavy and therefore **inefficient**."

2. endurance

QUESTION KEYWORD	lacked the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**lacked the endurance** for longer trips."

3. technical

QUESTION KEYWORD	overcame ____ problems
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"solved many **technical** challenges."

4. submarine

QUESTION KEYWORD	raise interest in a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attempt to attract French support for his **submarine** Nautilus."

5. Clermont

QUESTION KEYWORD	passengers carried by a steamboat called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **Clermont** began a scheduled passenger steamboat service."

6. cargo

QUESTION KEYWORD	mostly ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"carrying **cargo** and occasionally passengers."

7. TRUE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	fuel economy needed for Atlantic crossings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Engines needed to use less coal so ships could remain at sea for several weeks."

8. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	paddle wheels guaranteed reliability
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Paddle wheels also had to be replaced by power sources **less affected by rolling seas**."

9. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Savannah much faster
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no speed comparison is given for the Savannah

10. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Brunel preferred railways
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	not discussed anywhere in the passage

11. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Great Britain more than one innovation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **first iron** ocean-going steamship and the **first to use a screw propeller**."

12. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Archimedes widely admired
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Archimedes" is not mentioned anywhere in the passage

13. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	modern ships same energy source
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Modern ships now use **steam turbines, diesel engines or fuel oil**" — different from early coal-fired steam engines.

Passage 2 — IQ Scores

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14. A — James Flynn

QUESTION KEYWORD	technology influenced intelligence
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"demands of visuo-spatial abilities have grown because of **TV, computers and cars**."

15. D — Thomas Teasdale

QUESTION KEYWORD	IQ scores not yet at natural limit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if such a ceiling had been reached, the test results should show scores **pushing against it rather than actually falling**."

16. C — Robert Howard

QUESTION KEYWORD	improved diet positive effect
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"helped by better **nutrition**, smaller families, wider access to education."

17. B — John Rust

QUESTION KEYWORD	exceptional individuals impact collective intelligence
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if just one mind grasps a new concept, such as **Einstein**... it may then be easier for society in general to think in a more complex way."

18. B — John Rust

QUESTION KEYWORD	sophisticated societies need more problem-solving
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in more complex societies, people have to **think harder** to find solutions."

19. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	selection procedure for particular group
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The Danish military still summons virtually all young men before a **draft board**."

20. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	component of visuo-spatial test
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'Raven's matrices' – sequential patterns with one piece missing."

21. A

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QUESTION KEYWORD	overview of different interpretations
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"psychologists disagree about what the upward trend in scores really means."

22. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	negative effect of affluence
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"prosperity often led to decadence, and... the case of ancient Rome."

23. mid-1980s

QUESTION KEYWORD	during the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"first showed that IQ scores were rising in the **mid-1980s**."

24. Raven's matrices

QUESTION KEYWORD	tests called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This last test category usually includes '**Raven's matrices**'."

25. verbal

QUESTION KEYWORD	numerical and ____ components
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**verbal** and arithmetical scores showed more modest rises."

26. countries

QUESTION KEYWORD	research in other ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Flynn has looked at data from further **countries**."

Passage 3 — Practical Learning in the Classroom

27. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	AIA education initiative
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the process of architectural design... is a beneficial aspect of the art curriculum."

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28. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	problem noted in third paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the technology and expertise required of modern architecture can **prohibit students from actually realizing their designs**."

29. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	greatest benefit for students
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"motivates students to invest **intellectually and emotionally in the outcome**."

30. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	purpose of eighth paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"draw students into important aspects of design... chemistry of soil... structural dynamics... **math skills**."

31. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	traditional building and general population
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cultural heritage that interests some;... quality of living... attracts others;... sustainability... for others."

32. D — storage

QUESTION KEYWORD	building used for ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Now it served as a place where old furniture could be kept."

33. C — design

QUESTION KEYWORD	functional ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"kept it relatively warm in the winter... due to its broad south face... stayed cool in summer" — its climate-responsive design.

34. F — resources

QUESTION KEYWORD	where to locate ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"showed us where to find local supplies of sand and clay soil for the plaster mix."

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35. A — Experts

QUESTION KEYWORD	worked closely with a number of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Preservationist Shalie Gasper... other local specialists joined us."

36. G — training

QUESTION KEYWORD	given ____ to build useful skills
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"three full mornings of intensive workshops on history and preservation as well as mud-plastering technique."

37. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	price of materials a drawback
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Traditional architectural materials, such as earth, clay and straw, are **cheap**."

38. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	easily built in all US regions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only New Mexico is discussed; no claim about all US regions

39. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	physical benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"solve problems, work with classmates, and **exercise muscles**."

40. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	best suited to middle school level
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no comparison to other age/grade levels is made

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 2 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — Australia's Cane Toad Problem

1. beetle

QUESTION KEYWORD	larvae of a type of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a species of **beetle** whose larvae... live underground."

2. roots

QUESTION KEYWORD	larvae ate the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"their **roots** were eaten by the larvae."

3. expensive

QUESTION KEYWORD	unsatisfactory because ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"not only **expensive** but also stayed in the environment."

4. gardeners

QUESTION KEYWORD	French ____ used toads
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"toads were sold to **gardeners** at markets in Paris."

5. moth

QUESTION KEYWORD	a ____ stopped the cactus
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"introduction of a **moth** from Argentina."

6. Hawaii

QUESTION KEYWORD	brought to Australia from ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"brought 101 cane toads from **Hawaii**."

7. failure

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QUESTION KEYWORD	proved to be a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it became clear that the cane toads were a **failure**."

8. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	outcome immediately obvious
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**over the following years** it became clear that the cane toads were a failure."

9. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	rabbits introduced to control weeds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	rabbits are only mentioned as a comparison ("as great a pest... as rabbits") — no reason for their own introduction is given

10. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Froggatt criticised
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Froggatt's peers rebuked him and eminent scientists branded his views 'decidedly pessimistic'."

11. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	average size increased since introduction
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only current average size ("10-15 cm") is given; no historical comparison

12. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Australian animals eat toads safely
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"freshwater crocodiles, goannas... and dingoes... have died after eating cane toads."

13. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	gaining control of habitats
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they are taking over more and more of the land where native Australian fauna live."

Passage 2 — Farmers

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14. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	company being sold
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it was taken over by Chase Corporation."

15. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	range of goods more limited
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"today it sells a **narrower assortment** of products than in the past."

16. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	innovative offer by founder
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"guaranteed customer satisfaction... a full refund with no questions asked."

17. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	romantic event on shop's roof
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the lookout tower on top of the Farmers building would be a unique place to fit the ring."

18. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	latest store in the chain
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Its most recent branch in the suburb of Albany."

19. mail order

QUESTION KEYWORD	set up as a/an ____ business
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"began one hundred years ago as a **mail order** company."

20. buying offices

QUESTION KEYWORD	set up ____ overseas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Laidlaw had established **buying offices** in New York and London."

21. large family

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QUESTION KEYWORD	according to employees, was like a/an ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they all emphasize how the company represented a **large family**."

22. annual sale

QUESTION KEYWORD	held a/an ____ once a year
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an **annual sale** to celebrate the birthday of Hector the Parrot."

23. E — Ian Hunter

QUESTION KEYWORD	integral part of local life
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'Coming to Farmers once a week has become woven into the fabric of New Zealand culture'."

24. D — Rawdon Busfield

QUESTION KEYWORD	staff believed in generosity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I took the penny and gave him the chocolate."

25. F — Rod McDermott

QUESTION KEYWORD	store needed to change approach
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we were focused too much on price and not on fashion. The reorientation of the last decade has seen a great improvement."

26. A — Lincoln Laidlaw

QUESTION KEYWORD	character changed for worse
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the original culture of the store was dispelled and it hasn't been recovered."

Passage 3 — Life on Mars?

27. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	rock originated on Mars
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ALH84001, a meteorite that was blasted into space... to crash into the Antarctic."

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28. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	plan to analyse material on Mars
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"conducting experiments to detect the presence of... carbon 13 in soil and rock samples on Mars."

29. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	reason Mars no longer like Earth
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Mars lost its magnetic field... Without that protection, Mars's gases and water boiled off."

30. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	currently water on Mars
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"water from underground reservoirs still gushes through Martian valleys as occasional flash floods."

31. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	construction had taken place
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"canals... had been built by technologically advanced Martians to transport water."

32. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	humans and Martians share origins
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"If DNA is located, it would mean that life on Mars and on Earth may spring from the same source."

33. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	Herschel believed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'its inhabitants enjoy a situation similar to our own'."

34. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	public ideas changed because of
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the British writer H.G. Wells in 1898 in his masterpiece **The War of the Worlds**."

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35. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	what happened in the 1960s
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sent back pictures, not of a world covered in vegetation, as many scientists still expected, but of... cratered, arid deserts."

36. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	extremophiles suggest
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"support for the idea that living organisms could survive Mars's harshness."

37. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	Lowell, Martian tech more advanced
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'Martian folk are possessed of inventions of which we have not dreamed'."

38. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Viking info unchallenged
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the meteorite's crystal evidence is disputed: "Others, however, argue that the crystals could have been laid down by simple chemical processes."

39. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	significant climate change
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Martian surface... was once lush and welcoming... Then catastrophe struck."

40. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Spanish scientists plan to launch probes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Perez Mercader discusses the implications of finding DNA, but no plan to launch probes is stated

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 3 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — The History of the Chicken

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	popular because of different cooking styles
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"chicken presents a blank canvas for the national flavours of almost any cuisine."

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	chicken flight vs junglefowl
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only the junglefowl's own limited flight is described; no explicit comparison to modern chickens is made

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	more than one ancestor
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Scientists have identified three closely related species that might have bred with the red junglefowl."

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	same skin colour as grey junglefowl
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"modern chickens inherited at least one trait — their yellow skin — from the grey junglefowl."

5. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	consumption declined after Roman Empire
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the chicken's status declined after the fall of the Roman Empire, and chicken farms disappeared."

6. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	criticism of factory farming
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	factory farming is described factually with no criticism mentioned

7. FALSE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	fewer people keeping expensive breeds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"exotic and heritage breeds are **increasingly** kept in backyards."

8. zoos

QUESTION KEYWORD	Egyptian ____, used in fights
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"fighting birds and additions to **zoos**."

9. tombs

QUESTION KEYWORD	pictures on the ____ of kings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Drawings of the birds decorated royal **tombs**."

10. incubation

QUESTION KEYWORD	egg ____ without hens
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Egyptians mastered the technique of artificial **incubation**."

11. humidity

QUESTION KEYWORD	heat and ____ levels stay same
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**humidity** must remain stable."

12. complexes

QUESTION KEYWORD	hatched in large ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"large oven-like **complexes** with corridors and vents."

13. vitamins

QUESTION KEYWORD	antibiotics and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"antibiotics and **vitamins** were added to chicken feed, allowing birds to be raised indoors."

Passage 2 — A Study of Introvert and Extrovert Characters

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14. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"These projects might be big (such as career ambitions) or small (like cleaning the car)."

15. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"think of ourselves as amateur scientists... exploring and testing... to discover what works."

16. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The reason for basing the research on this environment, as Balsari-Palsule explains..."

17. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"introvert employees make frequent use of 'restorative resources'."

18. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"extroverts report... much less rewarding[experiences]... extremely hard – and stressful – to rein back."

19. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"highly competitive environments... may leave little time... This could eventually be detrimental to their well-being."

20. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph G
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"organisations should adopt policies and build work environments that are supportive."

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21–22. **B, E**

QUESTION KEYWORD	statements by Little, first paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	B: "we adopt these free-traits only when we need them"; E: "allow us to behave in a manner which contrasts with our natural selves."

23. **level**

QUESTION KEYWORD	projects of personal ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"projects which are important to them on a personal **level**."

24. **implications**

QUESTION KEYWORD	many ____ for businesses
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **implications** of Little and Balsari Palsule's research are numerous."

25. **surveys**

QUESTION KEYWORD	depend too much on ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"handing out personality **surveys** that pigeonhole employees."

26. **productivity**

QUESTION KEYWORD	boost company's ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"likely to lead to increases in **productivity** in the long run."

Passage 3 — When the Senses Mix Together

27. **C — Simon Baron-Cohen**

QUESTION KEYWORD	hearing affects brain like seeing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"when synesthetes were listening to words, areas of the brain lit up that are normally only active in response to vision and colour."

28. **C — Simon Baron-Cohen**

QUESTION KEYWORD	consistent colour-symbol association

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"gave the same answers in 92 per cent of instances when tested again a week later."

29. B — John Locke

QUESTION KEYWORD	heard instrument seeing colour
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a man who experienced bright red as the sound of the trumpet."

30. A — Daniel Smilek

QUESTION KEYWORD	fresh perspectives on normal perception
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Synesthesia, because it's abnormal, can give us new insights into normal perception."

31. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	investigation using modern medical technology
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A brain scanning experiment by Baron-Cohen in 1995."

32. I

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer who was a synesthete
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the novelist Nabokov, who perceived the English 'a' as dark brown."

33. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	definition of synesthesia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"have synesthesia – meaning literally 'joined sensation'."

34. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	two explanations, uncommon in adults
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"connections are pruned... synesthetic mechanism no longer intact"; alternative: "the mechanism is intact in adults but repressed."

35. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	reason some don't tell people

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Others learn to keep it a secret for fear of people laughing at them."

36. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Kandinsky admired synesthetes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"believed synesthetes were like good, much-played violins."

37. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	no longer linked to mental illness
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"linked with the hallucinations of mental illness have long been disproved."

38. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	equal numbers men/women
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Women are between two and eight times more likely than men."

39. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	greater logic powers
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	not discussed anywhere in the passage

40. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	all born with synesthesia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we may all have synesthesia at birth, when many parts of the brain are linked."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 4 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — The Pixar Story

1. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Iger's opinion of Eisner
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no personal opinion of Eisner by Iger is stated

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	limited financial success early years
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"brought in practically no revenue... continued to lose money year after year."

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	difficulties producing Toy Story
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Disney considered ordering Pixar to shut down production... because of problems with the script."

4. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	commentators convinced of promising future
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Hollywood commentators doubted whether audiences would even sit through a full-length film."

5. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Finding Nemo more popular than Toy Story
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no direct popularity comparison is made between the two films

6. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Pixar contributed little to Disney's income
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Pixar films accounted for approximately **45 per cent** of the operating income."

7. operator

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QUESTION KEYWORD	ride ____ at Disneyland
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"working as a ride **operator** on Disneyland's Jungle Cruise."

8. confidence

QUESTION KEYWORD	increased his ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"helped him gain **confidence** in public speaking."

9. frustration

QUESTION KEYWORD	suffered ____ over rejection
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **frustration** he felt when Disney initially rejected computer animation technology."

10. president

QUESTION KEYWORD	Pixar's ____ at shareholder meeting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"then sixty-one years old and **president** of Pixar."

11. listening

QUESTION KEYWORD	preferred ____ to control
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"known for **listening** rather than dominating conversations."

12. vision

QUESTION KEYWORD	did not let go of his ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"maintained a long-term **vision** of fully computer-animated films."

13. core

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ of Pixar
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"assembled the technical and creative teams that would later form the **core** of Pixar."

Passage 2 — A Mechanical Friend for Children

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14. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	comparison of reactions to different robots
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"While hugging of QRIO increased, hugging of Robby decreased throughout the study."

15. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	speculation about robot communication
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"approximate social skills like facial expression and eye gaze."

16. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	changes in physical handling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"At first the toddlers would touch the robot on its face, but later on they would touch it only on its hands and arms."

17. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	connections with animals vs robots
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in sharp contrast to the long-term interactions and bonding that commonly develop between humans and their pets."

18. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	how a robot was programmed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"researchers sent instructions to the robot about every two minutes to do things like giggle, dance."

19. B — Javier R. Movellan

QUESTION KEYWORD	robots must think and show feelings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we are going to [need to] endow machines with something similar to emotion."

20. C — Ronald Arkin

QUESTION KEYWORD	uncertain if more contact is beneficial
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we do not yet understand the consequences of increased human/robot interaction."

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21. A — Fumihide Tanaka

QUESTION KEYWORD	young children no preconceived ideas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Children of toddler age were chosen because they have no preconceived notions of robots."

22. D — David Powers

QUESTION KEYWORD	need wide variety of actions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"as being able to make appropriate responses from a broad repertoire of behaviors."

23. A — Fumihide Tanaka

QUESTION KEYWORD	robots in schools may have benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It could have great potential in educational settings assisting teachers."

24. storytellers

QUESTION KEYWORD	best at holding attention were ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The most successful robots so far have been **storytellers**."

25. peer

QUESTION KEYWORD	friend or ____ rather than toy
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"children progressively treated it more as a **peer** than a plaything."

26. affection

QUESTION KEYWORD	Arkin expected ____ towards robot
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ronald Arkin was not surprised by the **affection** demonstrated by the toddlers."

Passage 3 — The Peopling of Patagonia

27. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's main point, first paragraph

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"gives a baseline that all calculations regarding the rate of dispersion... must take into account."

28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's purpose, second paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"fundamental disagreements developed... the debate is still with us today."

29. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	why refer to 'late' model
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the 'late' model is set up in contrast with the 'early' model discussed next

30. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	main point about 'early' model
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the most realistic scenario as migrants slowly adapted to the diverse natural habitats."

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	Monte Verde site
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"securely dated to around 12,500 years ago at the Monte Verde site, which casts doubt on the 'late' model."

32. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	conditions found nowhere else
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"similar to that of early post-glacial Europe."

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	highland settlers relied mainly on hunting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	subsistence methods are not discussed

34. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	no conclusions from rock-shelter evidence

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reliable evidence from these sites to confirm the presence of humans by around 11,000 years ago."

35. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	material relocated by natural processes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"bones or other evidence may be deposited in caves by natural agency... floods or predators."

36. D — good condition

QUESTION KEYWORD	found in ____ at Chinchihuapi Creek
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"buried in layers of peat, which has the property of preserving wood remarkably well."

37. B — random collection

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ of the Los Toldos sample
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dispersed flecks of carbon... taken unsystematically from many different places."

38. C — similar properties

QUESTION KEYWORD	Arroyo Feo remains show ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"found at the same depth and have the same origins as those from Los Toldos."

39. H — reliable connection

QUESTION KEYWORD	no ____ between Las Buitreras samples and humans
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no way of securely relating any of these remains with human occupation."

40. J — immediate surroundings

QUESTION KEYWORD	beyond the ____ area, Cueva Fell
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the utility of this site must be restricted to its direct vicinity."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 5 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — Western Immigration of Canada

1. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"as eastern agricultural land filled to capacity."

2. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"federal government took steps to secure western land... a Mounted Police Force."

3. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made imperative the building of a transcontinental railway."

4. x

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Winnipeg became the metropolis of the West during this period."

5. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Protestant English-speaking settlers... Austria-Hungary and Ukraine... First Nation Métis."

6. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Not all of the settlers who came to western Canada in the 1880s... desired to remain there."

7. xii

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QUESTION KEYWORD	heading, Paragraph H
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"presented Canada's attractions to potential overseas migrants... assisted passage schemes."

8. homesteads

QUESTION KEYWORD	supply ____ for descendants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"would provide **homesteads** for the sons and daughters of eastern farmers."

9. agricultural output

QUESTION KEYWORD	increase ____ of Canada
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"expanding Canada's **agricultural output**."

10. wheat

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ crop consumed in East
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"especially in terms of **wheat** production."

11. company

QUESTION KEYWORD	bought land from a private ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"purchased Rupert's Land from the Hudson's Bay **Company**."

12. police

QUESTION KEYWORD	mounted ____ found to secure land
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"created a Mounted **Police** Force in 1873."

13. railway

QUESTION KEYWORD	build a ____ to transport migrants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the building of a transcontinental **railway**."

Passage 2 — Why Don't We Sleep?

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14. prescriptions

QUESTION KEYWORD	high number of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Fifty-six million **prescriptions** for sleeping medication."

15. accidents

QUESTION KEYWORD	traffic ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"nearly 20 percent of all major **accidents** on the road."

16. productivity

QUESTION KEYWORD	effect on company ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"loss in terms of **productivity** within the workplace."

17. training

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ given at medical school
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no more than four hours of **training** on sleep disorders."

18. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	different cultural approaches
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Acupuncture... has long had this role in Asian medicine."

19. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep positive effect on health
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sleep helps boost the immune system and control infection."

20. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep kinds and mental performance
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"those who had engaged in REM sleep subsequently performed better in pattern recognition."

21. B

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QUESTION KEYWORD	species sleep differently
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"some insects and reptiles that only half sleep, in order to remain aware of their environment and predators."

22. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep removes insignificant info
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the purpose of sleep may be to help us remember what's important, by letting us forget what's not."

23. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	brain response when breathing stops
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"When the brain realizes it is not getting oxygen, it sends a signal to the body to wake up."

24. B — William Dement

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep as reaction to body's signals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the only reason we need to sleep that is really, really solid is because we get sleepy."

25. C — Clete Kushida

QUESTION KEYWORD	insomniacs easily recognisable
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I can spot most people's sleep problems right at the intake interview."

26. E — John Winkelman

QUESTION KEYWORD	therapy doesn't always give good sleep
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Some people continue in my experience to struggle... not super-satisfied with their sleep."

Passage 3 — Understanding Symbols

27. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	children's task, first paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"find 'Big Snoopy'... hiding in the same place in his big room."

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28. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	result of first experiment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"three-year-olds were very successful... found the large toy behind the real couch."

29. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	children and pictures, 4th paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"infants do not appreciate this duality — stories of a baby trying to pick up a depicted toy."

30. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	toddlers' reactions, third experiment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"most of the children showed little or no reaction to their failed attempts."

31. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	maths experiment implication
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the group using blocks took three times as long to do so."

32. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	DeLoache's conclusion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Less may be more when it comes to educational books for young children."

33. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	9-month-old test purpose
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We began testing infants' understanding of pictures."

34. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	third experiment revealed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attempted to perform the same actions with the miniature items that they had with the larger ones."

35. D

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QUESTION KEYWORD	maths experiment designed to assess
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	comparison of blocks vs. pencil-and-paper as teaching tools

36. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	first experiment unexpected info
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"research takes an unexpected but fruitful turn."

37. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	same reaction to drawings/photographs
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"when depicted objects bear little resemblance... as in a black and white drawing — infants rarely explore them" (vs. reaching for photographs).

38. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	toddlers used to failing tasks
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"toddlers' daily lives are full of unsuccessful attempts to do one thing or another."

39. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	little significance for education
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This confusion has implications for educational practice."

40. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	enjoy 3-D more than 2-D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only recognition/learning outcomes are compared, not enjoyment

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 6 (Volume 8)

Passage 1 — Optimism and Health

1. seven years

QUESTION KEYWORD	lengthen lifespan by ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"adds an average of **seven years** to a person's life."

2. 670

QUESTION KEYWORD	study on ____ male subjects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"eight-year study of **670** men aged about 63."

3. lung function

QUESTION KEYWORD	differences in the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"optimists had significantly better **lung function** than men who were more pessimistic."

4. immune system

QUESTION KEYWORD	makes the body's entire ____ stronger
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attitude somehow strengthens the **immune system**."

5. heart patients

QUESTION KEYWORD	Wright cites research on ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Preliminary studies on **heart patients** suggest that by changing a person's outlook, you can improve their mortality risk."

6. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Freud reference illustrates
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"from 1970 to 2000 there were 46,000 psychology papers on depression and only 40 on joy."

7. A

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QUESTION KEYWORD	Brice Pitt says
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'Optimists tend to be insufferable people... hopelessly rosy outlook.'"

8. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	Henley Centre researchers show
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"65 per cent better off financially... there is no evidence that they are any more content with their lives."

9. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	1995 Adweek survey found
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"That attitude drops, however, to less than a third of people between the ages of 55 and 64."

10. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Lynn Myers suggests
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a cock-eyed optimist, the sort of person who smokes but is convinced they will never get lung cancer."

11. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	link known for some time
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The role of optimism in good health has long been noted but often sidelined."

12. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	better personal relationships
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	not discussed anywhere in the passage

13. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	over-95s same amount of exercise
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"researchers generally fail to find **consistencies** in diet or exercise."

Passage 2 — New Technology in New Zealand's Health Service

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14. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	practice less common, now more frequent
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the home visit... has brought back a service that was becoming infrequent."

15. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	scheme more advanced than other nations
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"NHI number system was introduced in 1993, before most other countries in the world."

16. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	info systems tested small scale
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these trials are not big enough to determine if they could ever work at a national level."

17. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	most people experience urgent situation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"nearly all New Zealanders will have to attend an after-hours clinic following an emergency or accident."

18. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	dramatic event improved health IT
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the earthquake in Canterbury... was a catalyst for health IT in that region."

19. D — Kate Reid

QUESTION KEYWORD	invest in prevention not treatment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"infrastructure is not in place to allow funding to be shifted from treatment to prevention."

20. A — Ian McCrae

QUESTION KEYWORD	reasons healthcare lags in tech
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"because of concerns about patient privacy, but also because health care is just so complicated."

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21. D — Kate Reid

QUESTION KEYWORD	professionals must communicate
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"maintaining a dialogue... critical, but it's not easy because there are so many different agencies."

22. C — Richard Medlicott

QUESTION KEYWORD	focus on important work
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"free doctors from routine administrative tasks and instead allow them to focus on diagnosis and patient care."

23. eye

QUESTION KEYWORD	look into a patient's ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"allowing users to examine the **eye** with minimal training."

24. offices

QUESTION KEYWORD	for use in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	printed as given; the passage's phrase "particularly helpful in today's busy **offices**" describes the Clever MedKit in the following sentence, not Dr Chiong's eye-camera directly — likely a soft compression in the source's own summary wording, printed as given.

25. tooth

QUESTION KEYWORD	cost of repairing a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"pre-made ceramic fittings which can be placed over a broken **tooth** in a single sitting."

26. size

QUESTION KEYWORD	changes in the ____ of wounds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"detect small differences in wound **size** by collecting accurate images and data."

Passage 3 — Game Theory

27. C

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QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's suggestion, first paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"evaluates the ability of each of those players to influence others, and hence **predicts the course of events**."

28. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	van Oosten, predicting works best if
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sorting out people's motivations is much easier when making money is the main object."

29. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Milgrom instructed clients to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"directed to obtain a collection of smaller, less expensive licenses instead."

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	ice-cream seller example purpose
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Introduce a third seller, however, and the stifling equilibrium is broken as relocations and pricing changes energize the market."

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ponsati, negotiations progress if
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if a human mediator was not trusted, affordable, or available, a computer could do the job instead."

32. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	software unhelpful for political issues
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"predictions may become unreliable when people unexpectedly give in to 'non-rational' emotions such as hatred."

33. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Milgrom confident in 2006
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"He was **apprehensive** at first, but the result was a triumph."

34. NO

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QUESTION KEYWORD	mediation machines inappropriate outside business
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"such 'mediation machines' could be employed to push negotiations forward" — no restriction to business contexts is stated.

35. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	military orgs refuse to accept
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	not discussed anywhere in the passage

36. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	van Oosten, software fails when
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people unexpectedly give in to 'non-rational' emotions such as hatred."

37. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Milgrom's software detects if
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"determined that certain big licenses were being **overvalued**."

38. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Black's software helpful when
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"makes clients more inclined to look at future repercussions when making business decisions."

39. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ponsati, negotiators fall behind if
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the first side to disclose the maximum amount that it is willing to pay loses considerable bargaining power."

40. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	mediation machine useful when
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if neither side reveals the concessions it is prepared to make, negotiations can become very slow or collapse."

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